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WRITING and  
REWRITING

*by*

CARVER

MAULSBY *and*

KNOTT 1999

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KNOTT 1929

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\*\*\* START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK WRITING AND  
REWRITING \*\*\*

# WRITING AND REWRITING

BY  
GEORGE CARVER  
WILLIAM S. MAULSBY  
THOMAS A. KNOTT  
THE UNIVERSITY OF IOWA



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HARCOURT, BRACE AND COMPANY

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To  
THE MEMORY OF  
J. SCOTT CLARK

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## TO INSTRUCTORS

*Writing and Rewriting* is based on the conviction that college freshmen can be taught to see and to correct their own errors and faults.

Criticism by means of marginal numbers, referring to pieces of advice in a rhetoric or a manual, has long been utilized to economize the instructor's time. It has not been generally realized, however, that this method, which requires the student to inspect and rewrite a faulty sentence in the light of an illustration in his book, is successful also in teaching him to rewrite faulty sentences before he submits his manuscript to his instructor.

The best device to encourage the student in self-correction is the preliminary copy or rough draft. This may be written rapidly in pencil on theme paper or on scratch paper, with lines far apart to leave room for modifications. After this is written the student should read it with his eyes open for the appearance of his pet blunders, and should do his own rewriting. If the rough draft is submitted with the finished copy, the instructor can discover whether the student is endeavoring to correct his own faults.

The best way to use *Writing and Rewriting* in class is to copy the faulty passages or to clip and paste them on cards. In class the student, using only the slip, may then be required to write the correct version on the blackboard, later reciting and specifying the fault, or the principle of style which is violated.

In colleges where the marginal numbering of errors and faults is supplemented by personal conferences, the swiftest improvement will be found to follow the practice of requiring the student, before the conference, to copy his faulty passages on a new sheet of theme paper, to copy also the admonition indicated by the marginal number, and to rewrite each passage in accordance with the admonition. A file of these sheets will reveal whether the student is improving or standing still.

*Writing and Rewriting* has several relatively novel features. Chapters IV and V make it possible to criticize by marginal numbers the most common

violations of the principles of the whole composition and of the paragraph. Although the admonitions criticize faults, the book contains few “don’ts.” Instead, the advice given is positive, constructive, and concrete. Each number refers to only a single fault. Few admonitions fill more than two lines of type. It has thus been possible to insert a criticism of every fundamental fault found in freshman themes. Probably every number ought to be used at least once in every hundred themes. The division of sentence criticisms into chapters on Correctness, Clearness, and Vigor is logical and obvious. The numbering of admonitions is not consecutive, but a new hundred begins with each chapter as a help in more quickly locating the number desired. Additional copies of the index to the admonitions will be furnished free on request to instructors who wish to paste it on a sheet of cardboard to facilitate their work in criticizing themes. The list of suggestions for subjects is a compilation of the practices of many successful teachers.



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824. Around limiting clauses or phrases

825. With series of non-interchangeable adjectives

826. To indicate a pause

827. Before *that* in indirect discourse

828. Between unjoined main clauses

Use a semicolon between:

829. Unjoined main clauses

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# **WRITING AND REWRITING**

# CHAPTER I

## WHY LEARN TO WRITE

The four main reasons for learning to write are:

1. Writing is one of the best ways to make other persons think or feel as you do.
2. Every educated person is judged frequently and severely by the correctness and skill displayed in his writing.
3. The more you learn about writing the more you will enjoy reading.
4. Good writing gives pleasure, not only to the reader but also to the writer.

1. The ability to write clearly and convincingly will be of great help to you after you leave college. Whatever your field of activity, your ultimate success will depend in some degree on your ability to make other persons think or feel as you do. Writing is one of the best ways to attain this end.

Many professional men and women find that success depends not only on their knowledge, but even more on the skill and clearness with which they can present their knowledge. Lawyers write briefs and arguments. Judges write opinions. Clergymen write sermons. Teachers, doctors, and engineers get their new ideas before members of their professions by writing papers for publications of various kinds. The results of their experiments and researches are almost invariably presented to their colleagues in writing.

To attain eminence in one of the learned professions it is necessary for a man's colleagues to think highly of his professional knowledge and attainments. It is not always possible for the leaders in your profession to know you personally, but if you can write they soon know what manner of man you are. The scholarly articles that a young professional man gets printed correspond to the home runs that are knocked by a bush league baseball player, but there is this difference. The sand lot baseball player may have made his impressive looking records against sand lot pitching and

may fail dismally when he faces better opposition, but if a young professional man has the mental ability and the skill to produce contributions to knowledge in his field it makes no difference where he lives or under what conditions he has done his work. As he moves up to his big league he finds conditions more and more favorable for his continued growth and development.

College graduates everywhere are being expected more and more to assume positions of leadership in all matters that pertain to community betterment. Sometimes they are candidates for office; more often they are directors of the chamber of commerce of their city, or of some similar civic enterprise. Written statements, annual reports, appeals for public support for a worthy cause, letters to newspapers, circulars, and bulletins are almost the only way a public spirited citizen can get his ideas before the other members of the community. If he can write clearly and convincingly he gets things done that would not be done if he expressed himself haltingly and incoherently when he took pen in hand.

Up-to-date farmers and business men use printed and typewritten matter to get new business, to hold and increase old business, to adjust complaints, and to collect money. Every salesman has to write reports to his firm. Formal bids for all kinds of business are submitted in writing. Most busy executives prefer to receive the ideas of their subordinates in writing, and the subordinate who submits the largest number of good ideas in this way is the one who is likely to be promoted most rapidly. Many executives have to depend on letters and bulletins in directing large numbers of subordinates or in directing subordinates who cannot frequently be brought together. If you want to be paid for what you know rather than for what you do, learn to write.

Other things being anywhere nearly equal the man who can write gets ahead fastest in the business, political, or professional world. The man with a new idea—whether it is a new type of automobile engine or a plan for insuring hogs—can make a success of it far more quickly if he can write clearly and convincingly. The next time you see a copy of *Who's Who in America* note the list of publications that follows the name of the successful man. The ability to write has dollar and cents value whether or not you ever wish to sell any of your manuscripts. You must be able to write to get to the top.

2. Why do you suppose that almost every help wanted advertisement that offers a salary of more than \$1200 or \$1500 a year contains the phrase, “Apply by letter only”? The answer is that from one hundred letters it is easy to select the half dozen or so that come from persons qualified for a position rather than for a job. Applicants who write poor letters are never considered for good positions.

The activities of the social world continually call for letters—letters of invitation, of acceptance or declination, letters to a hostess thanking her for her hospitality, letters of congratulation and of condolence. Any new person to whom you write will judge what sort of man or woman you are from your first letter. Uneducated persons may have well furnished houses in the exclusive residential districts of the city, and they may wear thousand-dollar fur coats, but their written words betray the fact that they are not accustomed to associating with educated persons.

Students who can write get better grades in college courses than do students who cannot express themselves with pen, pencil, or typewriter. Written reports, term papers, and examinations all call for ability to write. It is essential not only to have the information that should be included in such compositions but also to be able to express your knowledge so that the instructor involved will know that you know.

3. The better you write the more you will enjoy reading. You can actually know personally only a few persons, and they will for the most part be your neighbors and business associates. A love for good reading is the best friend you can have. Reading will make you intimate with all the great men and women who are now alive or who have ever lived. These great ones of earth—the clever, the entertaining, the thoughtful, the lovable, the brilliant, the courageous—have set down in books a permanent record of what they observed, thought, and dreamed. To get the fullest flavor and greatest benefit from the words they have put on paper you need to be something of a writer yourself. The writer best appreciates the good writing of others, just as the amateur musician gets more pleasure from a symphony concert than does the average person in the audience. The football player sees fine points in a football game that are lost on the spectator who never tried to box a tackle or elude an end. The girl who makes her own clothes can see

distinctions in gowns that all look alike to her brother. It takes the craftsman in any field of endeavor to appreciate the work of a master.

4. Your mother has, at the bottom of a trunk or bureau drawer, a bundle of letters that your father wrote to her when they were young. Every little while she reads them all again. She also keeps the letters he writes her now when he is away from home. Your letters to your mother will not be destroyed either. The better you write, the more pleasure you will give to the persons you love. Letters of commendation, congratulation, or condolence when done well are treasured for years, and are a never failing source of pleasure to those who receive them. It is worth something to give pleasure of this sort.

But the greatest pleasure of all in writing is the pleasure that comes to you yourself. To get real enjoyment from writing you should write on a subject you know thoroughly or on one that interests you—preferably both. Write without reserve; call things by their right names. Use care in selecting the exact word to express your meaning. Write clearly, concisely, and vividly. Be definite and particular rather than indefinite and general. Use incidents freely to illustrate your points. Be forceful and picturesque. Write so that anyone who knows you could pick your written creation out of a thousand written by others on the same subject.

Write something you are proud of and you will get more pleasure from it than from almost anything else you ever did. Even though you may not yet have realized it, writing is a great deal more fun than going to the theater, dancing, or watching a football game. The greatest thrill in life comes from seeing one whom you love create something. The next greatest comes from creating something yourself. Create something in writing that truly represents you and you too will experience this joy.



## CHAPTER II

### HOW TO WRITE

The successive steps in writing are:

1. Have a subject that appeals to you, and write for an actual reader.
2. Gather all the material your subject demands.
3. Arrange your material in the most effective order.
4. Write as fast as you can.
5. Revise, recast, rewrite what you have written.

1. Write on a subject which interests you and one that you know something about. Good writing will not result merely from trying to satisfy an instructor. You can write well only if you have a compelling reason for writing; if you desire to convince, inform, or entertain a definite reader.

Know the state of mind you want your reader to be in when he finishes reading your composition. Write for a definite reader such as a college freshman, a high school student, an automobile owner, a ten-year-old boy, a proprietor of a retail store in a town of from 15,000 to 20,000 inhabitants. It will often be helpful if, after you choose the general class to whom your writing is addressed, you select one individual you know and keep him constantly in mind while you write. Thus instead of writing for a ten-year-old boy write for your brother Robert.

Choose a subject that can be covered in the number of words at your disposal. If you are writing a four-hundred-word theme, "The American High School" is a poor subject. It would take a series of volumes to exhaust the possibilities in that title. Even eliminating a large portion of it by taking the topic "High School Newspapers," "High School Debating," "High School Dramatics," or "High School Athletics," helps but little. Narrowing any one of these subjects so that it applies only to your own high school still leaves you with more material than can well be put into a short theme.

Good subjects for such themes are “The First Time I Faced an Audience,” “The Best Play I Ever Made,” “How I Felt When My Story Appeared in the School Paper,” and “The Most Exciting Play I Ever Saw in a Baseball Game.”

To take another example, “Cooking” is a subject broad enough for a Mrs. Ralston, a Mrs. Lincoln, or a Miss Farmer. “Making Desserts” is too comprehensive for any but an exhaustive treatise. “Making Ice Cream” requires at least a booklet. Good short theme subjects would be “How I Make My Favorite Sherbet,” “How to Make Chocolate Ice Cream without Cream,” or “How to Make Ice Cream Roll with a Frozen Whipped Cream Center.”

2. Reflect, read, ask questions, observe in order to gather material which will enable you to carry out your design. Gather, as applied to material for writing, implies a go-and-get-it attitude. Gathering material requires a physical as well as a mental search. Do not expect material to come to you; go after it. Talk with persons who know. Read what they have written. Good writing is most likely to result when the writer fuses his own experience and observation with the experience and observation of others. Gather all the material possible without trying to decide, while you are getting it, what is important and what is not. Keep your mind, your eyes, and your ears wide open. Get details and get plenty of them. Steep, saturate yourself in your subject.

3. After you have gathered the material, discard everything that will not help you to produce the effect you are trying for. Then if there are any gaps in your composition, gather more material to fill them up. Some writers get the best results by putting a plan on paper before starting to write; others let a plan take more or less definite shape in their minds, but do not try to set down any hard and fast outline. The reason for not making a hard and fast outline is that a curious thing often happens to any writer who has written much. He finds—on occasion—that his composition seems to write itself. The characters he thought he had created have minds of their own and refuse to let him treat them like puppets. His thoughts seem to be alive and to exist apart from him. They insist on expressing themselves in their own

way. An experienced writer does some of his best work when he seems to be merely the medium through which ideas are seeking to translate themselves from whatever world it is they inhabit to this one. If, on the other hand, a writer is continually consulting a plan, his ideas and characters never take things into their own hands.

Write for someone to read. Put yourself in that reader's place and see if your writing is producing the desired effect. Begin your composition with the details that will most effectively attract his attention and arouse his interest. Continue writing so that you will retain his attention and interest. Stop when you have said all you have to say.

4. Write rapidly and at white heat. If pertinent ideas keep coming to you forget about your plan. Get your inspiration on paper before it cools. If you finally find a system—or even a lack of one—that enables you to write fast and at the same time to feel that you are creating something, do not let anyone talk you into trying some other plan. Stick to your own.

5. Revise at leisure, but ruthlessly, in cold blood, and continue to revise, rearrange, and rewrite indefinitely until the finished product satisfies you.

Make the final draft absolutely correct. Avoid especially the common faults that denote the semi-illiterate man or woman. If you make errors that would not be made by a twelve-year-old child, your composition will get scant consideration from an intelligent reader. While revising, question everything, spelling, grammar, choice of words, punctuation; question the usefulness of each idea, and the arrangement of the parts of the completed composition.

Start writing soon enough to give yourself ample time for revision. Let the first draft get cold before you look at it again. If you wait several days after the first draft is finished you can approach your own writing as objectively as if it had been done by someone else. It will then be much easier to question every letter, every word, every phrase, every sentence, every paragraph, every idea, besides the whole composition and each of its parts.

Make everything in your composition justify itself. Whenever you are satisfied to do mediocre work the rest of the world is satisfied with the valuation you have set on yourself. Be your own severest critic. Show your own writing no mercy. Some of the world's most successful writers of advertisements as well as of novels have rewritten their best work time and again before giving it to the public. What reads smoothly takes hours of toil to produce.

Many good instructors insist on receiving two copies of every composition from each student; one a rough, lead pencil draft, and the other the finished manuscript.

## **CHAPTER III**

### **IDEAS FOR COMPOSITIONS**

My first play, circus, funeral, visit to a dentist's, dance, county fair, Fourth of July, airplane ride, sleigh ride, or meal in a sorority house.

Extracts from the real diary of a real freshman.

My favorite newspaper artist, cartoon, or comic strip.

Earning money while going to college or during the summer.

Write the chapter of your autobiography that will be headed "Early Years."

My hobbies or aversions.

How I won a prize or competed at a county or state fair.

What is the well-dressed young man or woman wearing this season?

My favorite magazine.

My favorite recipe.

Write an account of a student mass meeting.

How does any organization to which you belong compare with rival organizations?

How does it feel to belong to a fraternity or how does it feel not to belong?

Write an article for your high school paper telling why your college is the best.

Write a letter home asking for money.

Write a history of your reading.

Describe some locality you know intimately such as your neighborhood or your home town.

Where I eat.

When I made my big mistake.

Taking a psychological intelligence test.

The secret of making good fudge.

How I spend my spare time.

Give directions for making something such as a radio receiving set, an apron out of an old shirt, or anything that you can make that most persons can not.

The joys of hunting, camping out, canoeing, going to the theater, dancing, sitting around and talking, or anything else that you enjoy doing.

How I learned to swim or how I taught someone to swim.

An embarrassing situation.

When the joke was on me.

My nicest compliment.

Freshman registration.

My favorite movie star.

What is the best outdoor sport?

My most hated instructor.

A railroad station at train time.

Men or women I have worked for.

Running a high school paper, athletic team, or annual.

What will you do when you leave college?

An exciting moment.

What is one important thing that ought to be changed in the way your college is conducted?

If you were the principal of the high school from which you were graduated, what changes would you make?

How does it feel to be red-headed, left-handed, bald, or fat?

Why I am or am not a church member?

Describe how to give a dinner party for eight persons.

Are prices here higher than they are at home?

The most interesting person I know.

The perfect roommate.

The happiest person I know.

My idea of a good time.

Go to church Sunday and write an account of the sermon.

Write an account of the next athletic contest, banquet, or public lecture you attend.

Write an account of an interesting recitation.

One of your instructors this week will spend part of the class time discussing a problem of college, city, state, nation, or world interest. Write an account of what he says.

What do you think of dogs, cats, or rabbits for pets?

A day's fishing.

Why should anyone study Latin, Greek, mathematics, or any subject you like or dislike?

What is the matter with the college paper?

What do you think of the country, the city, or the small town as a place in which to live?

How should a living room be furnished?

How could you decrease your expenses one-fourth?

Draw a rough floor plan of the sort of house in which you would like to live and explain its advantages.

How to distinguish fifteen kinds of trees, birds, or automobiles.

What is your pet extravagance or economy?

Tell how to dress on \$100, on \$200, and on \$500 a year.

An automobile camping trip.

A backyard garden.

A Sunday school picnic.

Who are the half dozen greatest men or women who have ever lived?

How should a kitchen be laid out?

What are the tests of a good national fraternity?

How could more students be interested in debating?

Write an account of an interesting college tradition for your high school paper.

If you were Santa Claus, what would you give your home city for Christmas?

Pick a football team from the heroes of fiction or of history.

Write a good sized advertisement that could be sold to some merchant who does not advertise in one of the college publications.

What are the ten leading colleges in the country?

What is an educated man?

My alarm clock.

Write a plea to induce young men and women to stay on the farm or in the community where they were reared.

Should the higher grade go to the student who does well in his daily work or to the student who does well in an examination?

A woman's place is in the home.

How much money will it take to satisfy you five or ten years after graduation?

Do college athletes get too much publicity?

If you could arrange it, would you have your brother or sister earn some, all, or none of his or her expenses while going through college?

Every high school graduate should earn his own living for at least one year before he is allowed to enter college.

Describe the conditions under which your father and mother started housekeeping.



Recommend ten books for a classmate who has never been accustomed to read for pleasure.

What do college students read in the newspapers?

Rules of etiquette undergraduates ought to follow.

If you were a vocational adviser, what vocations would you advise the ten classmates you know best to follow?

If you could spend the summer in travel, where would you go?

What advice would you give to a boy or a girl who is going to enter your college next fall?

Being afraid.

A gloomy holiday.

How to furnish and decorate a north room.

What are the advantages of a small or of a large college?

Buying a new car.

What should be considered in criticizing an amateur dramatic performance or a speech?

What is the leading honor an undergraduate can win at your college?

How many things will you buy before you buy a car?

If you had an assured income for the rest of your life, how would you spend your time?

Should a washing machine be in every home?

What is a gentleman?

What are the tests of a good town?

Describe some eccentric person you know.

Describe the appearance of a friend so well that a stranger could pick him out of a crowd.

Write a short story based on a movie.

Write a movie based on a short story.

How do the fraternity chapters at your college compare with one another?

Write a letter to your mother to reach her on Mother's Day.

Write a letter to your father inviting him to attend Homecoming.

My mother's flower garden.

Our bird shelf.

How to keep cool in hot weather.

Pick an "all" team from the football players you have seen this fall.

Sounds that keep me awake at night.

Taking care of the baby.

The tribulations of a landlady.

Describe a scale by which students could rate their professors.

What are the advantages of making your own clothes?

Write in play form an account of a family quarrel or an account of what happens between the halves of a close football or basketball game.

In praise of idleness.

Take three small boys to a soda fountain and have an ice cream eating contest.

Children should be seen and not heard.

Tell why your father, mother, brother, or sister ought to be chosen mayor, superintendent of schools, cashier of the bank, or anything else.

How would it be possible for you to be elected president of your class, win a letter in athletics, make Phi Beta Kappa, run 100 miles in 48 hours total time, earn \$2,000 within the next year, or something else that now looks improbable?

What would happen if you could see a copy of a newspaper that would not be printed for another month?

What would you say if called on to speak at a college mass meeting?

Tipping ought to be abolished.

What will ten of your most intimate friends be doing ten years from now?

## CHAPTER IV

### THE WHOLE COMPOSITION

“Whole composition” is the name given to a completed piece of writing.

#### PRELIMINARIES

Go out and gather the material.

Write the first draft as fast as you can.

Revise everything you have written until the following requirements have been met.

**100. Indicate within the first few sentences what the composition is about.**

Some of the more common devices used by experienced writers in beginning a composition are listed below. You can begin almost anything you will be called upon to write in one of these ways or in a combination of two or more of them. Use a different beginning for each composition you write until you have tried a considerable number of them. After some practice you can quickly select the one beginning that is most appropriate both to your material and to your reader.

1. Make one or more startling assertions.
2. Ask one or more questions.
3. Say something clever.
4. Make one or more suppositions.
5. Contrast one thing with another.
6. Use direct discourse.
7. Use an incident.
8. Sketch in the background.
9. Introduce one of the characters.

10. Employ a preliminary summary.
11. Plunge your reader into suspense.
12. State the conclusion the reader is to reach.
13. Give personal details about yourself.
14. Talk about your reader.
15. State your reflections on the subject.
16. Explain why you are writing.
17. Invoke aid in accomplishing your purpose.
18. Quote a familiar saying.
19. Parody a familiar saying.
20. Quote what someone has said or written.
21. Quote what purports to be what someone has said or written.

**101. Keep the same point of view throughout.**

*Wrong.* If one wishes to enter a canoe safely, he should grasp both gunwales and lower himself to the seat. You should then push off from the shore.

*Better.* To enter a canoe safely, grasp both gunwales and lower yourself to the seat before pushing off from the shore.

*Wrong.* As he stood looking down the river he saw a house-boat plowing along; while behind him a fleet of coal barges sent ripples toward the shore.

*Better.* As he stood looking down the river he saw a house-boat plowing along. Turning around he noticed a fleet of coal barges sending ripples toward the shore.

*Wrong.* The taxi driver has an excellent opportunity to observe the life about him. All kinds and conditions of men and women make use of him at all hours of the day and night. Some think him merely a part of the machine he drives, some consider him no better than the dirt under their feet, and some—to be sure they are not many—treat him as if he were a living, breathing human being like themselves.

*Better.* The taxi driver has an excellent opportunity to observe the life about him. All kinds and conditions of men and women make use of him at all hours during the day and night. He finds that some treat him as if he were no better than the dirt under their feet, and some—to be sure they are not many—as if he were a living, breathing human being like themselves.

**102. Include everything that the reader will need for a thorough understanding of your subject.**

*Wrong.*

THE THEATER IN AMERICA

Between the years 1750 and 1814 many events took place which either helped or hindered the establishment of a permanent theater in America.

One of the big events that helped establish the theater in America was the coming of the Hallam company of actors. This company was made up of English actors who came from the West Indies. The company consisted of twelve adult members and three children. Every member of the group had ability as an actor, and, consequently, the company was successful. They first played at Yorktown, Virginia, in 1752. Then, after a season in Philadelphia, they went to New York. After a three months' stay in New York, they returned to the West Indies, where Mr. Hallam died. Here a Mr. Douglas reorganized the company and with them returned to this country.

Douglas, often called the "theater builder," did much for the future theater. He was a man of great strength and courage. Besides being a capable manager, he was also a good actor. Douglas built the first theater in America at Williamsburg, Virginia, and the first permanent theater at Philadelphia. He also built theaters at Annapolis and at Newport.

The greatest difficulty which the play companies had to overcome was the increasing opposition of some of the people toward the theater. Throughout the country people were fighting against the theater. Especially was this true of the people of the

North. The Southerners were fun-loving and pleasure-seeking, and the theater offered them a place of amusement. In many towns, however, laws were passed against acting. The opposition of the people was not directed so much toward the theater itself as toward the gambling and immorality which accompanied the theater of that day. Folders were distributed among the people explaining why the theater was not approved of and gradually the gambling and immorality disappeared. After this the theater improved and theater-going became better thought of throughout the country.

*Better.*

#### AN EARLY INFLUENCE IN THE AMERICAN THEATER

In the year 1752 the theater in America received a great aid through the coming of the Hallam company of actors....

The condition of the theater prior to this time left much to be desired....

The nature of the company was such that its influence was decidedly good....

Naturally the effect of this kind of player was toward the betterment of the theater....

#### **103. Omit anything that will distract the reader's attention.**

*Wrong.*

#### SCORING IN BASKETBALL

A score in basketball is made every time a player throws the ball into one of the baskets placed at each end of the court. In the West Branch High School the gymnasium is well equipped with everything the students need for their athletic contests....

*Better.* A score is made in basketball every time a player succeeds in throwing the ball into the basket guarded by his opponents. If this goal, as it is called, is made from the field, it counts two points. Sometimes, however, one team is given a free throw at the basket

as the result of a foul's being made. If the ball is caged under this circumstance, the foul goal, as it is called, counts one point.

**104. Writing that is serious in tone or purpose should include nothing that will destroy its seriousness.**

*Wrong.* Gypsies are a peculiar, wandering race of people that appeared in eastern Europe in the fourteenth century and that has now spread out into Asia, America, and parts of Africa. These people are easily distinguished from those among whom they rove by appearance, by language, and by behavior. In appearance they are slight, though very strong; in color, somewhat tawny. In language they are thought to resemble some long-lost Hindu tribe. In behavior they are *sneaky*, and a number of them are not above *chicken stealing*.

*Better.* Gypsies are a peculiar, wandering race of people.... In behavior they are *untrustworthy*, and a number of them are not above *petty thievery*.

**105. Writing that is light in tone or purpose should include nothing that will destroy its lightness.**

*Wrong.* Many different types are in evidence around Fitzgerald's boathouse in the spring. The type most frequently discovered, perhaps, is the lover. He comes, accompanied by his inamorata, in quest of a canoe, in which presently the two are drifting idly upon the ample bosom of Turtle creek. It is strange that lovers should sojourn here, for Turtle creek is anything rather than a background for romance.

*Better.* Many different types are in evidence around Fitzgerald's boathouse in spring.... Muddy water, sand dredges, a railway construction gang at work near at hand, the whole background is unheeded by the lovers—romance needs no setting.

**106. Arrange your ideas in some orderly sequence.**

Following are various kinds of sequence.



**107. Arrange ideas in chronological order.**

All day long we were happy as a wedding party.... Early in the morning.... When noon came.... At night....

**108. Arrange the divisions of the composition according to the relative position of the objects treated.**

As we entered the garden.... On the right.... On the left.... Directly before us.... Upon going into the house....

**109. Work from the abstract to the concrete.**

Freedom may be defined as the state of being free, but to how many of us is this actually illuminating? Let us take, for example, a man who has just been released from prison, where he has been closely guarded for more than ten years. What would be his idea of freedom?

**110. Work from summary to detail.**

When once the mania for news gathering claims its victim, everything he sees becomes potential news.

He looks for it on his way down town in the morning....

The restaurant at which he lunches is combed unconsciously for items....

In the lobby of hotels and theaters....

Even his relatives and close friends become his prey....

**111. Work from what is of most importance to what is less so.**

Mohammed VI, the Turkish sultan, fled from Constantinople on a British warship, bound for Malta, today. The sultan declared he was not abdicating, but was merely removing himself from immediate danger. He was accompanied by....

**112. Work from the familiar to the unfamiliar.**

Everybody has noticed the way a cat's claws are incased in tiny sheaths, but how many of us know why they should be? In the first place, the cat is descended from a wild animal whose way of obtaining food was to kill its prey and then tear it to pieces. Naturally when this animal struck into the dead body with its claws, the claws, being hook-like, would tend to remain fast. But nature found a way of overcoming the difficulty by incasing the claws in sheaths so that while the paw of the animal is still inside the carcass, the claw can be withdrawn into the sheath and the paw removed without hindrance. Perfection in nature extends even to such trifles as this.

**113. Work up to a climax.**

Now, as always before, it is the custom to give way to great manifestations of joy when the football team wins over a university that is much older and much better established. Just as soon as the report comes in that Drake is gaining, feeling begins to run high; when it is said that Drake is ahead, we begin to hold our breath; but when the report spreads that Drake has won, excitement breaks out like a vast tidal wave and sweeps everything before it.

**114. Weld paragraph to paragraph so that they will obviously be parts of the whole instead of separate units.**

Following are various methods of accomplishing this welding:

**115. Weld paragraph to paragraph by word connectives.**

On a summer evening the shores of Lake Tiberias are thronged with strange and interesting people.

Here are caravans from across the Arabian desert....

Above them a Bedouin drives his flocks....

Not far away a rich Arabian farmer....

Around him, around everyone, in fact, little Arabian boys....

Then, as the last rays of the sun disappear behind the Mountain of Beatitudes, ...

**116. Weld paragraph to paragraph by repetition.**

... Thus it is that I came to believe in ghosts.

But ghosts are not all that I came to believe in that summer....

**117. Weld paragraph to paragraph by recapitulation.**

... Guns, horses, motors, men, all thundered along the road, then, like dogs of war let loose at Armageddon.

The hunt was up; the scent was on the air—Germany was unchained....

**118. Weld paragraph to paragraph by announcing the divisions.**

The most attractive flower to me among all those that grow in my garden is the sweet pea, chiefly, I think, because of the delicacy of its color, form, and fragrance.

**119. Give each idea the space it deserves.**

*Wrong.* As the sun climbed higher, the spell of the dawn was broken, and the camp came to life. Soon the surface of the lake was dotted with bobbing heads. Upon the crests of the low hills farmers were seen beginning to plow. Milk carts rattled along the roads toward the creamery. All was in harmony to foretell a perfect day.

*Better.* As the sun climbed higher, the spell of the dawn was broken, and the camp began to come to life. Soon the surface of the lake was dotted with bobbing heads as the campers splashed about taking their dip before breakfast. There was much laughter and merry shouting; everybody was ready to have as much fun as he could. Across the lake the farmers were commencing to plow. And from the road behind came the rattle of milk carts on their way to the creamery. It was morning; the world was awake.

**120. Give each idea the position it deserves.**

*Wrong.* Here and there the long, shiny body of a fish shot out of the water and fell back with a faint splash. The lake changed from the deep blue reflected from the clear sky to all the brilliant colors of the sunset. The sun began to set long before it should have, according to the campers' ideas. Canoes crept out without a sound from the shore, and the campers enjoyed to the fullest their favorite time of the day. Gulls called back and forth and settled for the night on jutting sand bars.

*Better.* The sun began to set long before it should have, according to the campers' ideas. The lake changed in color from the deep blue that had been reflected from the clear sky to all the brilliance of the sunset. Here and there the long, shiny body of a fish shot out of the water and fell back with a gentle splash. Gulls called back and forth to one another and began to settle for the night on jutting sand bars. Now canoes crept from the shore without a sound, and the campers enjoyed to the full this their favorite hour of the day.

**121. End with whatever will give an impression of a well-rounded whole.**

... With all these hints of prospective fun, how easy it is to bang the books back upon the table and let the world go hang—on Friday night.

**122. Choose a title that will indicate in a word or a phrase what the composition is about. Be sure not to refer to the title in the body of the composition as if it were an integral part of the composition.**

*Wrong.*

FRIDAY NIGHT

This is the night of all the week to which I looked forward with the most pleasure.

*Better.*

THE BEST NIGHT IN THE WEEK

There is one night in the week that is, to me, more pleasant than any other. You know which one it is as well as I do, for it is your best friend, too.

### **123. Plan long compositions as you gather the material.**

Use cards or slips of paper of uniform size for making notes while reading. During the early stages of your reading, the various topics which you will discuss will begin to make their appearance. Make only one note on each card. After writing the note, write one or two words in the upper left-hand corner to indicate the topic treated in that note. As you accumulate notes, keep them sorted according to the topics.

When all the available sources of material have been utilized and all the notes taken, arrange the various stacks—one stack for each topic—by first spreading them out upon a table so that you can see readily all the topics at once. Then move the stacks about, thus trying out various arrangements until you have made one which seems logical and complete. You will then have a plan for your composition.

### **124. Revise for arrangement and development by making a plan of the composition after it is finished.**

By outlining the composition you have written, you will be able to see just how certain ideas bear upon the subject and are related to one another. Again, the outline will show you whether or not the ideas follow any orderly sequence. But best of all, perhaps, it will enable you to judge whether the composition omits anything that is vital for complete understanding, or contains something that distracts the reader's attention.

Following is a method for making a plan of the composition:

#### **STROKES MOST COMMONLY USED IN TENNIS**

Idea to be developed: In order to be a good tennis player one must master certain strokes.

##### **I. The service stroke**

##### **A. Position of body**

##### **1. Poised so that weight be added to stroke**

- a. Leans away from toss
- b. Follows racket in striking

B. Tossing ball

- 1. Ball at arm's length from shoulder
- 2. Held somewhat before body
- 3. Thrown lightly three or four feet in air

C. Striking ball

- 1. Racket raised to strike as ball descends
- 2. Force necessary
- 3. Accuracy necessary
  - a. Ball must strike court within bounds

I'. Dimensions of receiver's court.

Etc.

**125. Exercise.**

Following is a composition that is very poorly put together.

1. Make an outline of the whole, using only the topic sentence in each paragraph.

2. Strike out any topic which does not help to express the central idea. Reword any topic which can be made to serve its purpose better. Add any other topics which will aid in developing more fully the central idea. Combine topics that explain almost the same thing.

3. Make changes in the arrangement of topics so that each topic will stand in its proper relationship to every other.

4. Make an outline of every paragraph, using every sentence.

5. Shift sentences into positions where they will serve better to develop the topic. Strike out any that do not directly apply. Reword any that can be improved by rewording. Insert additional sentences where they are needed.

6. Shift sentences from one paragraph to another if they can thus be made to serve their purpose better.

7. Copy the material in the regulation form for a composition, taking care that there is proper transition from sentence to sentence, and from paragraph to paragraph.

8. Apply these admonitions to one of your own compositions and rewrite accordingly.

### WHY TAKE BOXING?

Boxing is a very interesting sport. When the child of kindergarten age first attends school he has his first experience with fighting. This happens at every meeting of boys and continues into the teens. Nearly every real American boy wants to learn how to protect himself, and a course in boxing is the best way to learn defense. In boxing, the individual learns where the best blows are planted and also how to ward off these blows. If a boy knows these punches he will not be imposed upon by his companions. Even in later life men often become quarrelsome and come to blows, but the man who has learned the fundamentals of boxing always comes out in the lead. If every man knew how to box, robberies would be less frequent because the victims would be less timid and would give battle to the bandits instead of allowing themselves to be held up by highwaymen. Thus, defense is an important element in boxing.

Moreover, boxing, besides aiding in defense, is a healthful sport. The body is developed greatly after one goes out for boxing as is shown by the increase or decrease in weight, as the case may be. The weight decreases if one has been in the habit of taking no exercise as he begins training, but the weight soon increases again as the body makes the proper readjustments. Persons who are fleshy soon lose their superfluous fat. With the adjustment of weight the muscles are developed. The arms and shoulders with their continuous exercise in delivering punches and warding off blows are highly developed. The muscles of the body are developed to a great extent by the continuous twisting and bending of the body. The legs become firmer and carry the body with ease after practice in boxing because of the rapid forward, backward, and side movements necessary.

Again, the body is developed in quickness by the practice of boxing. The boxer's mind is made more alert by the habitual practice. The muscles of the body also increase in quickness. They respond instantly to the will of the mind and thereby increase the ability to advance and retreat rapidly, to deliver and ward off punches. When the boxer has developed this quickness of sensory and muscular organs, he can grasp the intent of his opponent's actions more quickly and govern himself accordingly.

Boxing is a very well-known sport. It is widely popular both in Europe and in America. It originated several centuries ago. The main reason for the popularity of boxing is that it is a very interesting sport. The spectator is held by the rapid action of the boxers. In the early days of boxing the men were slow and relied chiefly upon strength, but the modern boxer has developed speed and uses short, quick blows. If the boxer of the past should fight the boxer of the present, the affair would be very one-sided, because the latter would soon tire out his opponent by his quickness.

Besides being interesting because of the violent action that is a natural part of the sport, it is also interesting from the point of view of the money-maker. Thousands of dollars are spent every year in developing winners. This was shown in our latest match, the Dempsey-Carpentier fight, in which many thousands of dollars were involved. An international spirit also prevails when boxers from two countries meet. This was indicated in the same match when all the Americans yelled for Jack and all the foreigners for Georges.

Boxing has grown in popularity through the ages because of its aid to health and because of its interesting features.



## CHAPTER V

### THE PARAGRAPH

A paragraph is an indented division of the whole composition. Beginning with an indentation, and usually ending with a partly blank last line, it constitutes a visible block of material on the page. The successive blocks relieve the strain on the reader and enable him to mark each step in the advance from division to division of the thought. In length the paragraph ordinarily ranges from 150 to 300 words.

**200. Indent the first word of each paragraph at least half an inch. In typing, indent five spaces. Every paragraph begins on a new line.**

**201. The last sentence in the paragraph sometimes ends before the right-hand margin of the page is reached. In this case the last line of the paragraph may be left partly blank. All other lines must be filled clear to the margin.**

**202. Do not indent every sentence as if it were a new paragraph.**

*Wrong.* At that time they reorganized a girls' basketball team which had been dropped two years before, and they made me jumping center.

Although our high school was not a large one, we played some very good games, and managed to make a good record for the four years.

In my last year we had a new superintendent who was interested in athletics, and we then had teams in basketball, football, baseball, and track.

*Right.* At that time they reorganized a girls' basketball team which had been dropped two years before, and they made me jumping center. Although our high school was not a large one, we played some very good games, and managed to make a good record for

the four years. In my last year we had a new superintendent who was interested in athletics, and we then had teams in basketball, football, baseball, and track.

**203. In representing conversation, begin a new paragraph with every change of speaker.**

*Wrong.* “Shall we go swimming after school tonight?” I asked. “No, I have to work,” John replied. “When can we go, then?” “Tomorrow night after school, or any time Saturday. I don’t have to work next Saturday at all.” “All right; let’s go tomorrow.”

*Right.* “Shall we go swimming after school tonight?” I asked.

“No, I have to work,” John replied.

“When can we go, then?”

“Tomorrow night after school, or any time Saturday. I don’t have to work next Saturday at all.”

“All right; let’s go tomorrow.”

**204. Form one paragraph out of two short paragraphs which actually constitute one division of the whole composition.**

*Wrong.* He always has a smile and a kind word for everyone. He tries to lift everyone with whom he comes in contact to a higher plane of living.

Much sorrow has come into his life, but it seems to have made him only kinder and more gentle.

*Better.* He always has a smile and a kind word for everyone. He tries to lift everyone with whom he comes in contact to a higher plane of living. Much sorrow has come into his life, but it seems to have made him only kinder and more gentle.

**205. Break up a paragraph that is too long into two or more paragraphs. The subject matter of each of the new paragraphs thus formed should constitute a natural subdivision of what was originally one paragraph.**

*Tedious.* Just like all children, Charlotte was not perfect, either in school or out. While she was in the second grade, she was sent home for making paper boats during study time, a fascinating pastime which the teacher did not approve of; and while she was in the fourth grade, she and a friend were sent to the superintendent for a lecture because out of curiosity they looked through the window of the school room one evening after closing time to watch a naughty schoolmate get his paddling. The grammar school days arrived at last, and with them came the habit of giggling and playing, at the expense of lessons and the trying of the teacher's patience and temper. During the first year in high school she calmed down and worked hard to establish a reputation. She was always very enthusiastic over athletics and yelled herself hoarse at basketball or football games. A great deal of her time was spent in reading books of various types and in out-of-doors sports. While she was a junior and also during the last year of her high school career, she helped her father with the book work in his office, thus getting a little experience along that line and also earning for herself some expense money. Commencement finally came, and she was graduated in a class of thirty-three with all the thrills and excitement which usually accompany that occasion.

*Better.* Just like all children, Charlotte was not perfect, either in school or out. While she was in the second grade, for instance, she was once sent home for making paper boats, a fascinating pastime for her, but one, however, of which the teacher did not approve, especially during study hours. Again, when she was in the fourth grade, one evening after school had closed for the day she and a friend peeped through the school room window out of curiosity to see a naughty schoolmate get his paddling. The result was a lecture from the superintendent the next day.

Grammar school days arrived at last, and with them came the habit of giggling and playing, at the expense of lessons and of trying the teacher's patience and temper. During her first year in high school, however, she calmed down and worked hard to establish a reputation. She was very enthusiastic over athletics

and frequently yelled herself hoarse at basketball or football games. Much of her time at this period of her life was spent in reading books of various types and in out-of-door sports.

Nevertheless, while she was a junior and also during her senior year, she found time to help her father with the book work in his office, and so acquired a little business experience and also earned some expense money. And finally, when commencement came, she was graduated along with thirty-three others amid all the thrills and excitement that usually accompany this memorable occasion.

**206. Avoid a violent break in thought within the paragraph.**

*Wrong.* At the age of five I entered the public school. The second day in school began the happiest days of my life with a good whipping. This whipping brought into my life the best friend I ever had. After eight years of the closest friendship he passed out of my life. It was then that the realization of what a mother could be swept over me. Until this time my mother had been a person to go to when in trouble. She now appeared to me in the new light of a pal.

*Better.* At the age of five I entered the public school. A good whipping, which I received my second day in school, not only ushered in the happiest days of my life, but also brought me one of the best friends I have ever had, Mr. Clark, the superintendent. During my eight years in that school he remained my closest friend, and it was not until I had finished there and Mr. Clark had passed out of my life that I began to realize what a real friend my mother could be.

Until this time my mother had been only a person to whom I could go when I was in trouble; now she appeared more like a pal.

**207. Discard any material that does not belong in the paragraph.**

*Wrong.* When evening comes and his day's work is completed, he hurries home to his family. He is not extravagant in his home, but

has it neatly furnished. If the weather is favorable, he takes them all for a drive in the country, or they go visiting, or do something else which he arranges for the pleasure of those he loves.

*Better.* When evening comes and his day's work is completed, he hurries home to his family. If the weather is favorable, he takes them all for a drive in the country, or they go visiting, or do something else which he arranges for the pleasure of those he loves.

**208. The substance of a good paragraph can usually be summed up in a single sentence. It is often advantageous to put such a sentence, called a topic sentence, at or near the beginning of the paragraph.**

*Example.* Of all the places for summer dreams the best is a California beach. There the blended sights and sounds form a quiet setting for fanciful thoughts. The old Pacific rolls in its oily swells with only a rippling murmur; the droning roar of the surf a half mile down the shoreline rises from the tug of waves on tons of pebbles; the white hull of a launch is dipping, dipping far out upon the water, its regular exhausts sounding faint and thin. These sights and sounds are dreamy and far off; under the mood of them the quiet mind builds sweet, lazy air castles, to be forgotten and renewed.

**209. Arrange ideas in some definite order within the paragraph. ([See 106-113.](#))**

*Example.* A fence has been the evil genius of my life. It was not a remarkable fence, either; just a neat picket fence painted white. It surrounded a beautiful, well-kept lawn and guarded an old, pretty house which overflowed with books and toys. But the toys would sometimes become tiresome, and I would look wistfully through the fence at the children playing across the street. I would have liked to join them or to have them come over—but there stood the fence. I learned to read and gradually built up a play world of my own until one day I realized that I liked the fence. I no longer cared to play with the other children, and when I went to school I found that I could not play with them. The fence had followed

me. The years outside the fence have changed me somewhat, but still whenever I am in a group of young people I have a feeling that I am not one of them. I want to stand back and watch them play. Some people call my backwardness shyness or timidity, others call it pouting and attribute it to a disagreeable disposition, but I know what it is: it is a neat picket fence painted white.

**210. Link sentence to sentence within the paragraph by using words and phrases of reference, such as *he, this, then, however, of course*.**

*Example.* There is a delicacy about sweet peas that makes them more attractive to me than any other flower in my garden. Notice the way the blossom is joined to the stem. *It* is poised there with such nice balance that at the least puff of air the flower sways on its long green stalk with the rhythm of the wind. *And, too*, their delicacy of color is beyond that of most flowers. Really, the only thing I can think of to compare with them is the clouds at sunrise. If you have noticed, the colors *then* are fresh and vivid from the light behind the clouds, though a faint mist makes them more elusive than the colors of broad day. In the sweet peas the *same* airy, translucent color is repeated—the wan white, the sober purple blending into lavender, the rose in infinite variety. And there are other things, *besides*—the dewy freshness that clings to them all day, the coolness of them, the faint perfume—which make me think them different from the rest of the flowers in my garden and which set them apart from all the others in delicacy.

**211. Link sentence to sentence within the paragraph by causing each to grow out of the one preceding.**

*Example.* A university is an institution of higher learning. For purposes of ministering the better to the various demands made upon it, it is made up of a number of colleges, as the college of medicine, the college of law, that of engineering, of liberal arts, of commerce, for instance, each college being in charge of an officer called the dean. The colleges, in turn, are composed of various departments, such as the department of Romance languages, of art, and of home economics; these are under the charge of officers

called department heads or professors. And finally, each department presents many courses of instruction, like French, rhetoric, European history, and architectural drawing, each course being taught directly by an officer called an instructor or professor. Hence, although from the variety of its interests and the complexity of its activities it would seem that a university is an awkward, ungainly organism, nevertheless, if one examines it closely, one finds that it is a highly organized and smoothly running machine.

**212. Avoid an inconsistent change in number within the paragraph.**

*Wrong.* Here we find what amusements occupy his or her time. This is where their chief characteristics can be pointed out. Then a word here, an oddly written phrase there, or a lack of words gives us a clue to the nature of the student.

*Better.* Here we find what amusements occupy his time. This is where his chief characteristics can be pointed out. Then a word here, an oddly written phrase there, or a lack of words gives us a clue to the nature of the student.

**213. Avoid an inconsistent change in person within the paragraph.**

*Wrong.* One learns to like some students, of whom there are too few upon the campus. Others I dislike, and of these there are too many.

*Better.* One learns to like some students, of whom there are too few upon the campus. Others one dislikes, and of these there are too many.

**214. Avoid an inconsistent change in tense within the paragraph.**

*Wrong.* My flower garden in June is a most interesting and beautiful sight. On a bright sunny morning one would stop in amazement; the flowers were so happy when the sun reached their faces, still wet with dew, that they fairly sparkled.

*Better.* My flower garden in June is a most interesting and beautiful sight. On a bright sunny morning one stops in amazement; the

flowers are so happy when the sun reaches their faces, still wet with dew, that they fairly sparkle.

**215. Avoid an inconsistent change in voice within the paragraph.**

*Wrong.* His directions were brief and to the point. Every question I asked was answered by just the information I desired—no more, no less. When dictating he used only the simplest words. All inquiries in letters were answered plainly.

*Better.* His directions were brief and to the point. He answered my questions with just the information I desired—no more, no less. When dictating he used only the simplest words and always answered plainly all inquiries in letters.

**216. Avoid an inconsistent change in mood within the paragraph.**

*Wrong.* If you were to visit the library on Saturday afternoon, you would find it nearly deserted. The tables would be empty and the reading room very quiet. The students are upon the river or are enjoying themselves upon the campus. Someone, however, who has a paper to get in may be busy at the reference shelves.

*Better.* If you were to visit the library on Saturday afternoon, you would find it nearly deserted. The tables would be empty and the reading room very quiet. The students would be upon the river or enjoying themselves about the campus. Someone, however, who had a paper to get in might be busy at the reference shelves.

**217. Put the most significant idea near the beginning or the end of the paragraph.**

*Example.* Far as he could see through the gathering dark there was quiet, the reaction after tremendous exertion. Shapes of men surrounded him. Here lay one flat upon his back, his features sketched in sharp focus by the fading light. Three yards to one side sat two bodies leaning back to back, heads upon breasts, helmets over eyes. Beyond them huddled an indistinguishable mass. On the other side, so close he could have touched them, an arm and a leg strung along in a line—no torso within a rod of



them. The world lay desolate and silent except for the yellowing moon and the far off, intermittent firing.

*Example.* My one worry and regret, however, was the fact that my father was the president of the school board. Part of my teachers gave me good grades because they were afraid they would lose their positions if they did otherwise, and the rest of them tried to flunk me because they thought they were not being paid highly enough. Among them all I managed to make about a B average, and the problem which now remains for the university to solve is, did I receive more or less than I deserved while in high school.

## **218. Give most space to the most significant idea.**

*Example.* Since man's progress through the ages is a passage from the undeveloped to the highly developed, one wonders what the buildings of a thousand years from now will be like. From that day in the remote past, when the first cliff dweller conceived the idea of enlarging his home by carving out another terrace in the rock above it, to this day when we have a skyscraper 750 feet high, man's building has approached nearer and nearer to the clouds. As the little two-story terrace grew, the cliff dwellers wondered and doubted. Likewise, when a four-story building was a fact accomplished by our great-grandfathers, to live in a ten-story building would have been considered extremely hazardous. And now since we have the forty-story Singer building, will man continue to aspire to the clouds or will he remain satisfied with his achievement?

## **219. Practice.**

Here is a paragraph that is very poorly put together. On the basis of what you have just studied, answer the following questions and rewrite the paragraph accordingly.

1. What about the indentation?
2. What about the right-hand margin?
3. Should the speech of the mother be given a whole paragraph?

4. Is it possible to form more than one good paragraph of this thought? Why, or why not?

5. Does a break occur in the thought? Where?

6. Should anything be discarded? What?

7. Can you find a topic sentence, or must you compose one?

8. What about the arrangement of ideas?

9. Can you improve the links between sentences? How?

10. Can you give more prominence to significant ideas? How?

Perhaps it was from her father that she got her restlessness. Accidentally she put her finger on the label of what looked to be the top of an ordinary hat, and the flat shape she held immediately took the form of a hat. Her only ideas regarding him came through an incident that happened when she was about fourteen.

She had never seen him, and her mother never mentioned his name. Her father lived in her mind as an ideal. She rushed, filled with questions, to her mother, for as long as she could remember there had never been a man in the house, and she had never seen such a hat except in pictures. Her mother was anything but romantic. She and her mother had been giving their house its fall cleaning, and she had found, wrapped up in an old silk comforter, what she took to be a hat—it was shaped like one except that it had no crown. “Your father’s,” had been the mother’s laconic answer, her lips drawing into a hard, straight line that forbade further questioning.

## **CHAPTER VI**

### **GRAMMAR**

In this short discussion of grammar the attempt is not made to discuss exhaustively all the features of English grammar. The purpose is only to survey and to identify all the elements of an ordinary sentence. The definitions are few, and are descriptions rather than formal definitions. The parts of speech are treated as they become important in the structure of the sentence. Such a treatment of essentials as this is necessary partly as a review, but especially because a teacher and a student cannot discuss many of the commonest sentence faults unless they have a mutually intelligible terminology. A student must be able to recognize such grammatical elements as a subject or an object, a participle or an infinitive, a phrase or a clause, in order to produce correct and effective sentences. There is a minimum amount of grammatical knowledge without which a writer cannot rewrite his compositions so as to avoid the commonest errors and imperfections.

### **What Grammar Is**

Grammar is the study of the structure of sentences, and of the forms and functions of words and word-groups within sentences. In simple terms, grammar is the examination of the machinery of language.

### **Sentences**

Sentences make assertions (declarative sentences), or ask questions (interrogative sentences), or give commands (imperative sentences), or express emotion (exclamatory sentences). Written sentences begin with a capital letter and end with a period, a question mark, or an exclamation point.

The most common kind of written sentence is that which makes an assertion. This kind, called declarative, may well be taken, therefore, as the

most available basis for the discussion of the machinery of the sentence. The word sentence in this chapter will accordingly mean a declarative sentence.

## **The Parts of a Sentence—Subject and Predicate**

A sentence has at least two parts—a subject and a predicate.

The *subject* is that part which designates what the assertion is about.

The *predicate* is that part which makes the assertion.

Many students earn their way through college.

It is obvious that *Many students* designates what the assertion is about, and is therefore the subject. *Earn their way through college* makes the assertion about *Many students*, and is, therefore, the predicate.

Although the sentence may contain other elements, although the subject or the predicate or both may be long and complicated, and although the elements making up the subject and the predicate may be variously arranged, nevertheless every normal declarative sentence contains these two parts, and can be divided into these two parts.

## **Subjects**

The fundamental word or element in the subject is a noun, a pronoun, a gerund, an infinitive, or a clause.

A *noun* is simply a name word. It may signify a person or an animate being (Frank, boy, dog), an object (tree, box), a color (red), an action (walking, step, discussion), a quality (goodness), an abstract idea (truth, space), a general idea (speed, thing), to name only a few kinds of nouns. But it is always the name of an individual or of a class of persons or things.

A *pronoun* is a substitute or symbol word which signifies a noun which is either expressed near the pronoun or implied by the circumstances (he, it, who, anyone, I, you).

A *gerund* is a noun made by adding the suffix -ing to a verb (walking, hoping, sitting, being).

An *infinitive* is a form of a verb, usually preceded by the word *to*, often used to name the action signified by the verb (to think, to have gone).

A *clause* is a sentence element consisting of a subject (in the nominative case) and a predicate (with the verb in a finite form—that is, not an infinitive or a participle).

1. *Noun*: Time flies.
2. *Pronoun*: He arrived late. Everybody was late. I can do it.
3. *Gerund*: Standing on the corner made him cold.
4. *Infinitive*: To tell the truth was easy.
5. *Clause*: That he hath wronged me doth appear in this. Where he stood makes no difference.

## Predicates

The fundamental word in the predicate is the verb.

A *verb* is a word—or a word-group—the function of which is to assert something about the subject.

The tide rises.

The sun shone.

I bought a book.

The box is small.

The verb may consist of one word—as in the examples given—or it may consist of a group of words, called a verb-group, containing sometimes as many as five words. This verb group consists of one, two, three, or four auxiliary verbs, followed by a form of the verb expressing the meaning or sense. The form of the sense-verb is an infinitive, a present participle, or a past participle.

The moon will rise.

The moon is rising.

The moon has risen.

He may light the lamp.

He is going to light the lamp.

The lamp at last was lighted.

The lamp has been lighted.

The lamp may have been lighted.

He may have been going to light the lamp.

### **Structural Parts of the Predicate—Objects**

*Intransitive verbs* are those which, like *rise*, make assertions the action of which does not involve any person or thing other than the subject.

*Transitive verbs* are those which, like *light*, make assertions which involve some person or thing other than the subject in the action of the verb. In the sentence *He lighted the lamp*, *lamp* is such an *object*.

The same verb may sometimes assert one, and sometimes the other kind of action.

The door opened.

He opened the door.

Some transitive verbs make an assertion which involves two nouns, both signifying the same thing or person.

The club elected Frank president.

Some transitive verbs make an assertion which involves two different objects or persons.

I gave Frank an apple.

She bought Frank an apple.

I told him a story.

Here *apple* or *story* is the object directly affected by the action of the verb, and is, therefore, called the *direct object*. *Frank* or *him* designates the person for whose benefit the action of the verb affects the direct object, and is called the *indirect object*.

## Copulas and Complements

Still another kind of verb, called a *copula*, though it does not take a direct object, makes only part of the assertion. The rest is made by means of another word (or element) which characterizes the subject but which is an essential part of the assertion. In fact, the *complement*, as the element completing the verb is called, is the most significant part of the predicate; the verb is merely a bit of machinery by means of which the complement is turned into an assertion.

The sky is red.

The dark shape was a house.

The car looks cheap.

He is in the house.

Home is where the heart is.

In these sentences, *red*, *a house*, *cheap*, *in the house*, and *where the heart is*, are parts of the predicate, though they characterize the subject. Such elements are called *complements* because they complete the assertion of the verb; if adjectives, they are called *adjective complements*, or better, *predicated adjectives*; if nouns, they are called *noun complements*, or *predicated nouns*; if clauses or phrases, they are called *complements*, or *predicated phrases* or *clauses*. The verbs by means of which these complements are predicated are called *copulas*.

## Modifiers

Almost every word in the sentence is capable of having its meaning described, restricted, emphasized, or toned down in some way—that is, any meaning in the sentence may be characterized or modified.

Heavy automobiles run smoothly.

*Heavy* both describes and restricts *automobiles*.

Words which characterize nouns in this way are called *adjectives*.

*Smoothly* describes and restricts *run*.

Words which characterize verbs are called *adverbs*.

Very heavy automobiles run much more smoothly.

*Very* emphasizes *heavy*. A word which thus characterizes an adjective is called an *adverb*.

*More* characterizes *smoothly*. *Much* characterizes *more*. A word which characterizes an adverb is called an *adverb*.

## **Prepositional Phrases**

Nouns, pronouns, verbs, adjectives, and adverbs are also frequently described or limited in the same way by an element or group of words called a *prepositional phrase*. This usually consists of a noun, pronoun, or gerund whose exact relationship to the modified word is shown by means of a *preposition*. The preposition is placed before the modifying noun or pronoun and its adjective modifiers.

At home

In the house

With large tires

Over rough roads

Heavy automobiles with large tires run smoothly over rough roads.

*With large tires* is a prepositional phrase, consisting of the preposition *with* and its object *tires*; the phrase modifies or characterizes *automobiles*.

*Over rough roads* is a prepositional phrase which characterizes *run*.

A prepositional phrase characterizing a noun is called an *adjective prepositional phrase*. One characterizing a verb is called an *adverbial prepositional phrase*.

## **Subordinate Clauses**

A *clause* is any part of a sentence consisting of a subject in the nominative case and a predicate containing a verb in a finite form (not a



participle or an infinitive). Some clauses are used as nouns; others are used to characterize or modify nouns, pronouns, verbs, adjectives, or adverbs. Clauses used as nouns are called *noun clauses*. Those used as adjectives are called *adjective* or *relative clauses*. Those used to modify verbs, adjectives, or adverbs are called *adverb clauses*.

## **Noun Clauses**

*Noun clauses* may be used in practically any construction in which a noun is used.

|                               |                                                                      |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Subject:</i>               | That he is a good workman is clear enough.                           |
| <i>Appositive:</i>            | The fact that the paper is new disproves his claim.                  |
| <i>Predicated noun:</i>       | The weather will be what fate determines.                            |
| <i>Object of verb:</i>        | I saw that he had finished.                                          |
| <i>Object of preposition:</i> | The book is satisfactory except that it omits one essential feature. |

## **Adjective Clauses**

*Adjective clauses* are those which modify a noun or a pronoun.

Heavy automobiles which carry large loads run smoothly.

## **Adverb Clauses**

*Adverb clauses* usually modify a verb. They characterize the verb in several different ways.

|                    |                                                 |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Time:</i>       | He hurt his wrist when he fell.                 |
| <i>Place:</i>      | I put the glass where I could reach it.         |
| <i>Cause:</i>      | We stopped the car because it was raining.      |
| <i>Concession:</i> | Although it was still dark I awoke.             |
| <i>Condition:</i>  | If you read widely you will not be ignorant.    |
| <i>Purpose:</i>    | He broke the stone that he might find a fossil. |
| <i>Result:</i>     | He struck the vase so that it fell over.        |

*Manner:* They work as they please.

Adverb clauses of degree, and sometimes those of manner and of result modify an adverb or an adjective.

The cherries tasted sweeter than they looked.

He sawed the plank as carefully as he could.

We traveled so slowly that I despaired of reaching our destination.

## Participles

The *participle* is any form of the verb used as an adjective. There are several forms: *rising, risen, having risen; raising, raised, having raised, being raised, having been raised.*

The rising sun awakened me.

The fallen tree lay across the ravine.

The wind, howling a gale, swept the sea.

Twisting out of my hands, he escaped in the darkness.

The tree, twisted and broken, rotted away.

## Infinitives

The *infinitive* is usually preceded by its sign, *to*, but after some verbs (*do, shall, will, may, can, dare, help, need, see, hear, feel, let, make, bid*) and after the expressions *had better, had rather*, it is usually the pure or root infinitive without *to*.

There are six forms of the infinitive:

|              | <i>Simple</i> | <i>Progressive</i>  | <i>Passive</i>     |
|--------------|---------------|---------------------|--------------------|
| <i>Pres.</i> | to take       | to be taking        | to be taken        |
| <i>Perf.</i> | to have taken | to have been taking | to have been taken |

The infinitive has various uses:

|                                                        |                                             |
|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <i>Subject:</i>                                        | To command is his ambition.                 |
| <i>Predicated noun:</i>                                | To know is to act.                          |
| <i>Object of verb:</i>                                 | I prefer to travel slowly.                  |
| <i>After nouns:</i>                                    | We have work to do.                         |
| <i>After verbs:</i>                                    | He failed to pass his<br>examinations.      |
|                                                        | He seemed to be in trouble.                 |
|                                                        | Children had better be silent.              |
| <i>After verbs (with noun or pronoun<br/>subject):</i> | Our neighbors helped us move.               |
| <i>After adjectives:</i>                               | They are glad to hear the news.             |
|                                                        | He is so foolish as to believe the<br>tale. |

## Conjunctions

It is often necessary or desirable to join together two or more similar words, elements, or clauses in a sentence. Two nouns constituting the subject, for example, may have the same assertion made about them.

Time and tide wait for no man.

*And*, which joins *time* and *tide*, is a *conjunction*.

Two adjectives, two verbs, two adverbs, two prepositional phrases, or two clauses may be joined together with a conjunction.

The flag is colored red and blue.

Time came and went.

Men and women laughed and cried.

The rains descended, and the floods came.

The automobile is fast, but the airplane is faster.

Words like *and* and *but* are conjunctions.

Conjunctions which connect words, phrases, or clauses of equal grammatical value are called *co-ordinating conjunctions*.

The most frequent are *and*, *but*, *or*, *nor*, *for*.

*Subordinating conjunctions* are used to join a subordinate clause—noun, adjective, or adverb—to another clause or to some word in another clause. At the same time they show the exact significance and bearing of the subordinate clause.

We heard that the train was wrecked.

He came because I called him.

He remained though he wanted to go.

If it rains I shall stay at home.

Subordinating conjunctions are also sometimes used to join participles or adjectives to the rest of the sentence. In such cases, the participle or the adjective modifies a noun.

Though moving slowly, the train was gaining.

Though faithful to his master, the dog was shot.

## **Structure of Sentences**

According to certain features of their structure, sentences are classified as *simple*, *compound*, or *complex*.

A *simple sentence* is one consisting of a single clause or assertion.

Time flies.

Time came and went.

Time and tide wait for no man.

Men and women laughed and cried.

The subject of a simple sentence may consist of one noun or pronoun with its modifiers, or of two or more nouns with their modifiers. In the latter case, the subject is called a *compound subject*. Similarly, the predicate may contain one verb or two or more verbs. Occasionally a sentence will have a compound subject and a compound predicate, as in the last example given.

## Compound Sentences

A *compound sentence* is one which consists of two or more assertions of equal grammatical value—that is, neither assertion is grammatically subordinate to the other or to any part of the other.

The rain descended, and the floods came.

The automobile is fast, but the airplane is faster.

## Complex Sentences

A *complex sentence* is one which contains not only a main assertion (or more than one), but also one or more subordinate assertions—that is, it contains one or more assertions which are grammatically incorporated as a noun or an adjective or an adverb into the main clause or into another subordinate clause.

I saw that he had finished.

Heavy automobiles which carry large loads run smoothly.

The weather will be what fate determines.

He broke the stone that he might find a fossil.

## Absolute Elements

Most of the elements of a sentence have a clear grammatical relation to one another. But there are pieces of structure which have no evident relationship to anything else.

*Noun absolute:* He lay down, his heart heavy with sorrow.

Hat in hand, he came down stairs.

The *participle absolute* is more frequent.

*Participle absolute:* This said, he sat down.

One of them having fallen, the rest ran away.

The teacher absenting himself, there was no school.

## Parenthetical Elements

*Parenthetical elements*, like *so to speak*, *it is hoped*, *it is reported*, *they remark*, which have no grammatical connection with the rest of the assertion, occur frequently. Sometimes they are inclosed within dashes, sometimes within parentheses, sometimes within commas.

This action, it is expected, will produce results.

## Flexibility of the Sentence Elements

Although the sentence has a normal order—subject, verb, object; or subject, verb, complement—it is rich and varied in the possibilities it possesses of variety and rearrangement, especially in the position of adjective, participial, and adverbial elements, and in the case of adverb clauses.

*Adjective:*       The gloomy and portentous mountains towered above him.  
                          Gloomy and portentous, the mountains towered above him.  
                          The mountains, gloomy and portentous, towered above him.

*Adverb:*         The building may have been entered immediately.  
                          The building may have been immediately entered.  
                          The building may have immediately been entered.  
                          Immediately the building was entered.  
                          The building was immediately entered.  
                          The building was entered immediately.

*Adverb*  
*Clauses:*        As soon as he had knocked, he opened the door.  
                          He opened the door as soon as he had knocked.

## Inflections

Nouns, pronouns, verbs, and two adjectives show changes in function and meaning by means of changes in form, by endings, or, sometimes in the case of verbs, by prefixing auxiliary verbs.

## Noun Declension

Nouns are declined to show case and number.

|                   | <i>Singular</i> | <i>Plural</i> |
|-------------------|-----------------|---------------|
| <i>Common</i>     | boy             | boys          |
| <i>Possessive</i> | boy's           | boys'         |
| <i>Common</i>     | man             | men           |
| <i>Possessive</i> | man's           | men's         |
| <i>Common</i>     | child           | children      |
| <i>Possessive</i> | child's         | children's    |

## Pronoun Declension

Pronouns are declined to show case and number.

|                   | <i>Singular</i>       | <i>Plural</i> |
|-------------------|-----------------------|---------------|
| <i>Nominative</i> | I                     | we            |
| <i>Possessive</i> | my                    | our           |
| <i>Objective</i>  | me                    | us            |
|                   | thou                  | you           |
|                   | thy                   | your          |
|                   | thee                  | you           |
|                   | he      she      it   | they          |
|                   | his      her      its | their         |
|                   | him      her      it  | them          |
|                   | who                   |               |
|                   | whose                 |               |
|                   | whom                  |               |

## Adjective Declension

Two adjectives show differences in number.

*Singular Plural*

this        these

that        those

## Verb Conjugation

Verbs are conjugated to show person, number, tense, mood, and voice. Most of these changes are shown by the use of auxiliary verbs, which are placed before the infinitive or the past or present participle of the sense-verb. The combinations are called verb-groups.

### Indicative Mood

#### PRESENT (Simple or habitual)

##### *Active*

##### *Passive*

I take

I am taken

You take

You are taken

He takes

He is taken

We take

We are taken

#### PRESENT (Progressive or definite)

I am taking

I am being taken

#### PAST (Simple)

I took

I was taken

#### PAST (Progressive or definite)

I was taking

I was being taken

#### FUTURE (Formal)

I shall take

I shall be taken

You will take

You will be taken

He will take

He will be taken



|                |                    |
|----------------|--------------------|
| We shall take  | We shall be taken  |
| You will take  | You will be taken  |
| They will take | They will be taken |

#### FUTURE (Colloquial)

|                       |                           |
|-----------------------|---------------------------|
| I am going to take    | I am going to be taken    |
| You are going to take | You are going to be taken |
| He is going to take   | He is going to be taken   |
| We are going to take  | We are going to be taken  |

#### PRESENT PERFECT (Simple)

|               |                    |
|---------------|--------------------|
| I have taken  | I have been taken  |
| He has taken  | He has been taken  |
| We have taken | We have been taken |

#### PRESENT PERFECT (Progressive or definite)

I have been taking (Wanting)

#### PAST PERFECT (Simple)

|             |                  |
|-------------|------------------|
| I had taken | I had been taken |
|-------------|------------------|

#### PAST PERFECT (Progressive or definite)

I had been taking (Wanting)

#### FUTURE PERFECT

|                    |                         |
|--------------------|-------------------------|
| I shall have taken | I shall have been taken |
|--------------------|-------------------------|

#### COLLOQUIAL PASSIVE WITH *GET*

|         |                      |
|---------|----------------------|
| PRESENT | It is getting broken |
| PAST    | It got broken        |
| FUTURE  | It will get broken   |

#### Subjunctive Mood

##### PRESENT

##### *Active*

##### *Passive*

|             |                 |
|-------------|-----------------|
| I may take  | I may be taken  |
| I can take  | I can be taken  |
| I must take | I must be taken |

##### PAST

|               |                   |
|---------------|-------------------|
| I might take  | I might be taken  |
| I should take | I should be taken |
| He would take | He would be taken |
| I could take  | I could be taken  |

## Conjugation of *Be*

*Be* is an extremely irregular composite verb. It is made up of three verbs, *is* (*am, are, art*), *be*, and *was* (*were*).

### Indicative

| <i>Present</i> | <i>Past</i> |
|----------------|-------------|
| I am           | I was       |
| You are        | You were    |
| He is          | He was      |
| We are         | We were     |
| You are        | You were    |
| They are       | They were   |

### Subjunctive

| <i>Present</i> | <i>Past</i> |
|----------------|-------------|
| I be           | I were      |
| You be         | You were    |
| He be          | He were     |
| We be          | We were     |
| You be         | You were    |
| They be        | They were   |

## CHAPTER VII

### SENTENCE CORRECTNESS

The language spoken and written by educated persons and by trained writers in all parts of the English-speaking world has certain forms and usages to which everyone must conform if he wishes to be recognized as a well-educated man or woman. Conformity to the word-forms and to the sentence structure of this widespread language is called correctness.

**300. Use the nominative case for the subject of every finite verb. *I, thou, he, she, we, they, who*, are nominatives.**

*Wrong.* Him and I graduated last year.

*Right.* He and I graduated last year.

*Revise.* Us and her went by ourselves.

**301. Use the nominative form *who* for the subject, even if a parenthetical *he says, he thinks, etc.*, intervenes between subject and verb.**

*Wrong.* She was the teacher whom we thought had seen us.

*Right.* She was the teacher who we thought had seen us.

*Revise.* He whom everybody thought would win the prize came out second.

**302. Use the nominative forms *who, whoever* for the subject of a subordinate clause, even if a verb or a preposition immediately precedes *who, whoever*.**

*Wrong.* I shall believe whomever has the best argument.

*Right.* I shall believe whoever has the best argument.

*Wrong.* A reward was offered to whomever returned the lost book.

*Right.* A reward was offered to whoever returned the lost book.

*Revise.* The decision as to whom should be punished no longer rests with me.

**303. Use the nominative case for a predicated pronoun after *is, are, was, were, etc.***

*Wrong.* It was me.

*Right.* It was I.

*Wrong.* The best friends I have are her and him.

*Right.* The best friends I have are she and he.

*Revise.* It is not whom you think it is.

**304. Put a pronoun used as an appositive into the same case as the noun with which it is in apposition.**

*Wrong.* Let's you and I go.

*Right.* Let's you and me go.

*Wrong.* The principal called in several pupils, Jack and Mary and I.

*Right.* The principal called in several pupils, Jack and Mary and me.

*Revise.* For whom did you ask—they and she?

**305. After the conjunctions *as* and *than*, put the pronoun into the same case as that of the noun or pronoun with which the comparison is made. (Exception: The form *whom* is usually used after *than*.)**

*Wrong.* He swims better than me.

*Right.* He swims better than I.

*Wrong.* She is as rich as him.

*Right.* She is as rich as he.

*Wrong.* It improved him more than I.

*Right.* It improved him more than me.

*Right.* He is a student than whom there is none better.

*Revise.* I like him better than she.

**306. Use the possessive case of a noun or pronoun with a gerund.**

*Wrong.* I am tired of you going away like this.

*Right.* I am tired of your going away like this.

*Wrong.* Had you not heard of him being ill?

*Right.* Had you not heard of his being ill?

*Revise.* I will not consider Henry leaving.

*Revise.* Too much attention was paid to Ethel being rewarded.

**307. Put only nouns indicating persons or animate beings into the possessive case.**

*Wrong.* Biography is history's most interesting part.

*Right.* Biography is the most interesting part of history.

*Revise.* His striking appearance held the class's attention.

**308. Use the objective case of a pronoun which is the object of a verb or of a preposition.**

*Wrong.* My father decided that the farm was the best place for my brother and I.

*Right.* My father decided that the farm was the best place for my brother and me.

*Revise.* Most of we girls are studying household art.

**309. Use the objective case of a pronoun which is the subject of an infinitive after a verb of saying, thinking, permitting, etc.**

*Wrong.* Our parents let my sister and I drive the horse.

*Right.* Our parents let my sister and me drive the horse.

*Revise.* Who do you want to be captain?

**310. Use the objective case of a pronoun which is predicated after to be, to have been, used with a verb of saying, thinking, etc.**

*Wrong.* He thought it to be we.

*Right.* He thought it to be us.

*Wrong.* They believed her to have been I.

*Right.* They believed her to have been me.

*Revise.* We wished it to be they.

**311. Use *this kind of, that kind of, this sort of*, even if followed by a plural noun.**

*Wrong.* You cannot use those sort of films.

*Right.* You cannot use that sort of films.

*Revise.* Did you ever see these kind of instruments?

**312. Refer a singular pronoun to a singular antecedent.**

*Wrong.* He carefully crated and boxed the seed to stand weathering, and shipped them to India.

*Right.* He carefully crated and boxed the seed to stand weathering, and shipped it to India.

*Wrong.* Everyone did justice to their appetite.

*Right.* Everyone did justice to his appetite.

*Revise.* One can tell when they come to these villages because of the smell of the cod.

**313. Make the verb agree with its subject.**

*Wrong.* The first five years of my life was spent here.

*Right.* The first five years of my life were spent here.

*Revise.* Magazines, especially the *American*, is what I enjoy reading.

**314. Make the verb agree with its subject. *Each, each one, every, everyone, everybody, anyone, anybody, either, neither, none, no one, nobody*, are singular.**

*Wrong.* Neither of these treat the subject thoroughly.

*Right.* Neither of these treats the subject thoroughly.

*Wrong.* Oh, how I wanted a bicycle. Everyone either got one or were going to get one.

*Right.* Oh, how I wanted a bicycle. Everyone either got one or was going to get one.

*Revise.* For that reason almost everybody there get sleepy.

**315. Make the verb agree with its subject. Two or more singular nouns joined by *and* form a plural subject.**

*Wrong.* Across the street is the engineering building and the university heating plant.

*Right.* Across the street are the engineering building and the university heating plant.

*Revise.* Both the plot and the style was very good.

**316. Make the verb agree with its subject. Singular nouns or pronouns joined by *or* or *nor* form a singular subject.**

*Wrong.* Clarabell or Sue are going.

*Right.* Clarabell or Sue is going.

*Wrong.* Neither Henry nor Herbert were well treated.

*Right.* Neither Henry nor Herbert was well treated.

*Revise.* Either the captain or the sergeant have made a mistake.

**317. Make the verb agree with its subject. A collective noun requires a singular verb if the group is regarded as a unit, a plural verb if it is regarded as a collection of individuals.**

*Wrong.* She drills us on a lesson until she is sure the class are familiar with everything in each assignment.

*Right.* She drills us on a lesson until she is sure the class is familiar with everything in each assignment.

*Wrong.* Sometimes when some member of the class makes a mistake in his speech, the rest of the class laugh and talk about it.

*Right.* Sometimes when some member of the class makes a mistake in his speech, the rest of the class laughs and talks about it.

*Revise.* Another committee, known as the advisory committee, is composed of one member from each district, and are chosen by the board of the district bank represented.

**318. Make the verb agree with its subject. An intervening noun must not attract the verb into a different form.**

*Wrong.* The number of bearings in a car vary.

*Right.* The number of bearings in a car varies.

*Wrong.* The grounds upon which the building stands consists of half a city block.

*Right.* The grounds upon which the building stands consist of half a city block.

*Revise.* A copy of the orders are also sent to the checker.

**319. Make the verb agree with its subject. *There is* and *there are* must agree with the subject which follows.**

*Wrong.* There is always a few minutes now and then for reading newspapers.

*Right.* There are always a few minutes now and then for reading newspapers.

*Revise.* As I think of my subject there seems to be many phases open for investigation.

**320. Make the verb agree with its subject. Phrases introduced by *besides, with, together with, accompanied by, including, as well as*, do not affect the number of the verb.**

*Wrong.* The major, as well as all the lieutenants, were soon out in the open.

*Right.* The major, as well as all the lieutenants, was soon out in the open.



*Wrong.* Mary, together with Florence, Mabel, and Pearl, are going to be there.

*Right.* Mary, together with Florence, Mabel, and Pearl, is going to be there.

*Revise.* The whole army, including the Fifth and Seventh corps, have received orders to entrain.

**321. Make the verb agree with its subject. If both singular and plural substantives joined by *or* or *nor* make up the subject, the number of the verb depends upon that of the nearest substantive.**

*Wrong.* Neither the directors nor the president are in sympathy with the proposal.

*Right.* Neither the directors nor the president is in sympathy with the proposal.

*Revise.* The rodmill or the furnaces goes on double turn today.

**322. Make the verb agree with its subject. Verbs used with *who*, *which*, *that*, must agree in person and number with the antecedent of the pronoun.**

*Wrong.* Each man and woman who were present came away disgruntled.

*Right.* Each man and woman who was present came away disgruntled.

*Revise.* These horses that stands here are not for sale.

**323. Make the verb agree with its subject—not with a predicated noun or nouns.**

*Wrong.* The type of literature I enjoy are books of travel.

*Right.* The type of literature I enjoy is books of travel.

*Revise.* Another group of novels I have read are *Main Street*, *The Bright Shawl*, and *If Winter Comes*.

**324. Make the verb agree with its subject. The form *don't* is correct in the first and second persons singular and in all persons plural. The**

**form *doesn't* is the only correct form in the third person singular.**

*Wrong.* He don't seem to know us.

*Right.* He doesn't seem to know us.

*Revise.* The majority don't think.

**325. Distinguish between the past tense and the past participle of irregular verbs.**

| <i>Present</i> | <i>Past</i> | <i>Past Participle</i> |
|----------------|-------------|------------------------|
| He begins      | he began    | he has begun           |
| He blows       | he blew     | he has blown           |
| It breaks      | it broke    | it has broken          |
| He comes       | he came     | he has come            |
| He does        | he did      | he has done            |
| He draws       | he drew     | he has drawn           |
| He drinks      | he drank    | he has drunk           |
| He drives      | he drove    | he has driven          |
| He eats        | he ate      | he has eaten           |
| He falls       | he fell     | he has fallen          |
| He flies       | he flew     | he has flown           |
| It freezes     | it froze    | it has frozen          |
| It grows       | it grew     | it has grown           |
| He goes        | he went     | he has gone            |
| He knows       | he knew     | he has known           |
| He rides       | he rode     | he has ridden          |
| It rings       | it rang     | it has rung            |
| It rises       | it rose     | it has risen           |
| He runs        | he ran      | he has run             |
| He sees        | he saw      | he has seen            |
| It shakes      | it shook    | it has shaken          |
| It shrinks     | it shrank   | it has shrunk          |
| He sings       | he sang     | he has sung            |
| He speaks      | he spoke    | he has spoken          |

|           |          |               |
|-----------|----------|---------------|
| He steals | he stole | he has stolen |
| He swims  | he swam  | he has swum   |
| He takes  | he took  | he has taken  |
| It tears  | it tore  | it has torn   |
| He throws | he threw | he has thrown |

*Revise.*

I wonder what he has did?

Have you saw him?

He has ran the car into the ditch.

**326. Use the correct past tense or past participle of the following verbs —not the illiterate form.**

| <i>Present</i> | <i>Past</i> | <i>Past Participle</i>                   |
|----------------|-------------|------------------------------------------|
| It bursts      | it burst    | it has burst                             |
| He catches     | he caught   | he has caught                            |
| He dives       | he dived    | he has dived                             |
| He drags       | he dragged  | he has dragged                           |
| He draws       | he drew     | he has drawn                             |
| He drowns      | he drowned  | he has drowned                           |
| He eats        | he ate      | he has eaten                             |
| He grows       | he grew     | he has grown                             |
| He holds       | he held     | he has held                              |
| He knows       | he knew     | he has known                             |
| He leads       | he led      | he has led                               |
| He proves      | he proved   | he has proved                            |
| He shows       | he showed   | he has shown                             |
| He swears      | he swore    | he has sworn                             |
| He throws      | he threw    | he has thrown                            |
| He ought       | he ought    | ( <i>Had ought</i> is not in good usage) |

*Revise.*

What has she ate.

I drug it three yards.

I drawed him out.

He drowneded last week.

**327. Distinguish between *lie* and *lay*, *sit* and *set*, *rise* and *raise*.**

*Wrong.* He laid in the hammock all morning.

*Right.* He lay in the hammock all morning.

*Wrong.* All right, set there, then.

*Right.* All right, sit there, then.

*Wrong.* We all raised up and shouted.

*Right.* We all rose up and shouted.

*Revise.* I laid on the couch while the rest of them set around waiting for me to raise up and tell them to go home.

**328. Use *shall* in the first person, *will* in the second and third, to express simple futurity.**

*Wrong.* I feel that I have had more military training than I will get here in the university.

*Right.* I feel that I have had more military training than I shall get here in the university.

*Wrong.* You shall fail unless you get to work.

*Right.* You will fail unless you get to work.

*Revise.* He shall never be found if we do not hurry.

**329. Use *should* in the first person, *would* in the second and third, to express relative futurity.**

*Wrong.* I would like to give it to you.

*Right.* I should like to give it to you.

*Wrong.* He should be glad to help you, I'm sure.

*Right.* He would be glad to help you, I'm sure.

*Revise.* You shouldn't do that, should you?

**330. In questions, use *shall* in the first person. In the second and third persons, use that auxiliary which will be correctly used in the answer.**

*Wrong.* Will I help you?

*Right.* Shall I help you?

*Wrong.* Will you be at home tonight?

*Right.* Shall you be at home tonight?

*Revise.* Shall she be asked?

**331. To express determination on the part of the speaker, use *will* in the first person, *shall* in the second and third persons.**

*Wrong.* He will tell you; I am determined.

*Right.* He shall tell you; I am determined.

*Wrong.* You will go; I have decided.

*Right.* You shall go; I have decided.

*Revise.* I shall do it; nobody can prevent me.

**332. Make the tenses of parallel verbs conform to one another.**

*Wrong.* I would go down to the library every Saturday and there I got a book about radio.

*Right.* I would go down to the library every Saturday and there I would get a book about radio.

*Revise.* I traveled all over the state until I had seen everything or until I became tired.

**333. Use the present tense for assertions that are universally true.**

*Wrong.* Mars was the most nearly red of all the planets.

*Right.* Mars is the most nearly red of all the planets.

*Revise.* The earth was eight thousand miles in diameter.

**334. Make the tense of a verb in a subordinate clause relative to that of the verb in the main clause.**

*Wrong.* I also read new, popular novels that I would find in the public library.

*Right.* I also read new, popular novels that I found in the public library.

*Revise.* I probably would never have read such low, vulgar stuff if it were not for the war.

**335. Use the present tense of the infinitive unless its action is earlier than that of the main verb.**

*Wrong.* It was wrong for you to have gone.

*Right.* It was wrong for you to go.

*Wrong.* I ought to answer before that had happened.

*Right.* I ought to have answered before that had happened.

*Revise.* I intended to have told you.

**336. Use an adverb of time to show that the subordinate clause differs in time from the main clause.**

*Wrong.* The reason for the fertility of Iowa farm land is that an ice sheet spread over almost the entire area of the state.

*Right.* The reason for the fertility of Iowa farm land is that an ice sheet once spread over almost the entire area of the state.

*Revise.* One little corner of Iowa contains many steep hills because the ice did not reach it.

**337. Use the subjunctive mood in contrary to fact conditions.**

*Wrong.* If I was you, I should not do that.

*Right.* If I were you, I should not do that.

*Revise.* If he was not ill, he might win today.

**338. Use *have*, the correct auxiliary, not *of*, carelessly written for the unaccented *have*.**

*Wrong.* You should of seen him run.

*Right.* You should have seen him run.

*Revise.* If it had not rained today, we might of gone away.

**339. *Had ought* and *hadn't ought* are not standard English; *ought* has no past participle and no past perfect tense.**

*Wrong.* You hadn't ought to have come so soon.

*Right.* You ought not to have come so soon.

*Revise.* I had ought to have told you but I didn't have the courage.

**340. Make a complete sentence out of a fragment carelessly punctuated as if it were a sentence.**

*Wrong.* I took time to make friends and eventually enjoyed myself in the same way as any other little girl. My favorite sport being skating.

*Right.* I took time to make friends and eventually enjoyed myself in the same way as any other little girl. My favorite sport was skating.

*Revise.* At seven o'clock every morning I hear the faint tinkling of a bell which soon becomes an insistent ring, and another day has begun. Then a dash down the cold stairs followed by a hurried wash, then down to breakfast.

**341. Attach a phrase, carelessly punctuated as if it were a sentence, to the sentence to which it belongs.**

*Wrong.* This was placed in a chemical solution, called developer, for fifteen or twenty minutes. Sometimes even longer.

*Right.* This was placed in a chemical solution, called developer, for fifteen or twenty minutes, and sometimes even longer.

*Revise.* My office hours were unlimited during the summer months. Usually from seven in the morning until after six o'clock at night on week days.

**342. Attach a participial phrase, carelessly punctuated as if it were a sentence, to the sentence to which it belongs.**

*Wrong.* We arrived on the peak before sunrise. This being the best time to arrive.

*Right.* We arrived on the peak before sunrise, this being the best time.

*Revise.* Asher won the mile in 4:32. Thus breaking the record.

**343. Attach a subordinate clause, carelessly punctuated as if it were a sentence, to the sentence to which it belongs.**

*Wrong.* Soon after it is plowed. It should be harrowed several times in order to crush out all the lumps of dirt.

*Right.* Soon after it is plowed it should be harrowed several times in order to crush out all the lumps of dirt.

*Revise.* When the grain is dry enough to be threshed. The owner issues invitations for a threshing bee.

**344. Attach part of a compound subject, carelessly punctuated as if it were a sentence, to the sentence to which it belongs.**

*Wrong.* John, wearing a straw hat. Then his brother, garbed in a dress suit, entered the hall.

*Right.* John, wearing a straw hat, followed by his brother, garbed in a dress suit, entered the hall.

*Revise.* The memorial stadium and the chemistry building. The new administration building and the women's gymnasium have all been built since 1910.

**345. Attach part of a compound predicate, carelessly punctuated as if it were a sentence, to the sentence to which it belongs.**

*Wrong.* The beacon flared. And lighted up the darkness for miles.

*Right.* The beacon flared and lighted up the darkness for miles.

*Revise.* Who has ever heard of Dolliver? Much less has ever been there.



**346. Complete a construction begun but left unfinished.**

*Wrong.* They rediscount notes which arise out of and the proceeds of which are employed for agricultural, industrial, and commercial purposes.

*Right.* They rediscount notes which arise out of agricultural, industrial, and commercial transactions and employ the proceeds in similar transactions.

*Revise.* Anybody who could design an engine like that, the largest automobile manufacturers in the country would compete for his services.

**347. Give every finite verb a subject.**

*Wrong.* It has been about fifteen months since I left high school, and have not done any studying since.

*Right.* It has been about fifteen months since I left high school, and I have not done any studying since.

*Revise.* The town has not yet built a very large high school building, because there are not enough citizens to defray the expense and have not yet been able to obtain the co-operation of the farmers.

**348. Insert a word or words which have been carelessly omitted.**

*Wrong.* Their complexion is a reddish color.

*Right.* Their complexion is of a reddish color.

*Wrong.* Hundreds of small creeks were constructed by the association, for the benefit of an individual.

*Right.* Hundreds of small creeks were constructed by the association, each for the benefit of an individual.

*Revise.* I consider him my favorite poet not because of his style but of the feeling in his verse.

**349. Insert material necessary to make evident what is implied.**

*Wrong.* Mr. T.'s method of teaching is stimulating, but his lack of the English language makes him an undesirable instructor.

*Right.* Mr. T.'s method of teaching is stimulating, but his lack of knowledge of the English language makes him an undesirable instructor.

*Revise.* Douglas Fairbanks is truer to life than the book.

**350. Give every sentence element some grammatical construction.**

*Wrong.* In my American literature class the instructor thought that it was essential for us to study, at least once a week, that had to do with current happenings.

*Right.* In my American literature class the instructor thought that it was essential for us to study, at least once a week, something that had to do with current happenings.

*Revise.* You should select the ears that have medium-sized kernels and filled out well at each end.

**351. Use *that* to introduce noun clauses after verbs of saying, thinking, or feeling, unless the construction is obvious.**

*Wrong.* I have decided the topic for my long theme will be *Prehistoric Man*.

*Right.* I have decided that the topic for my long theme will be *Prehistoric Man*.

*Revise.* Father felt a secondhand car was beneath our dignity.

**352. Make the comparison accurate by inserting a demonstrative pronoun: *that of, those of, these which, etc.***

*Wrong.* Our condition is far better than the students of the East.

*Right.* Our condition is far better than that of the students of the East.

*Revise.* The history of the Book of Mormon is very much like the Bible.

**353. Insert *as* after the positive of an adjective or an adverb when it is followed by a conjunction and the comparative with *than*.**

*Wrong.* I am at least as tall or a little taller than anyone in the first squad.

*Right.* I am at least as tall as, or a little taller than, anyone in the first squad.

*Revise.* I enjoy biography as well if not better than fiction.

**354. Insert *much* or *greatly* between *very* and a past participle.**

*Wrong.* I was very disappointed.

*Right.* I was very much disappointed.

*Revise.* His table manners showed that they had been very neglected up to the time we took him in hand.

**355. Repeat the verb in a different person or number if necessary to make it agree with the second of two alternative subjects.**

*Wrong.* Either he or I goes.

*Right.* Either he goes or I go.

*Revise.* If he or I win the pole vault, Petersham will finish among the first three in the meet.

**356. Repeat the auxiliary verb if necessary to make it agree with a second subject in a different person or number.**

*Wrong.* Whether you or Jim is elected makes no difference to me.

*Right.* Whether you are elected or Jim is, makes no difference to me.

*Revise.* If you or any other student is caught cheating it means just one thing—expulsion of the guilty person.

**357. Repeat *is*, *are*, *was*, *were*, etc., if the verb is used both as a copula and as an auxiliary.**

*Wrong.* Their government was rude and founded solely upon custom.

*Right.* Their government was rude and was founded solely upon custom.

*Revise.* Our house is small and built to live in.

**358. Use the correct form of the verb after each of two auxiliaries which require two different forms.**

*Wrong.* I have always and always shall like cowboy stories.

*Right.* I have always liked and always shall like cowboy stories.

*Revise.* I hope I may in the future, as I have always in the past, play fair, whatever may be the provocation to do otherwise.

**359. Use the correct conjunction, *though* or *but* rather than *while*; *as soon as* rather than *immediately*; *if* rather than *so*.**

*Wrong.* Immediately I received the telegram I went home.

*Right.* As soon as I received the telegram I went home.

*Wrong.* It was in the latter part of my high school days when I did most of my reading.

*Right.* It was in the latter part of my high school days that I did most of my reading.

*Revise.* I had not gone to school long until it burned down.

**360. Use a transitional word, phrase, or clause to carry the reader from one unrelated idea to another.**

*Wrong.* I wanted to be popular; how could I start?

*Right.* I wanted to be popular, but the question was, how could I start.

*Revise.* Officers will be elected, and a good attendance is desired.

**361. Avoid shifting from one construction to another.**

*Wrong.* Consider the football season just ended, Merrill did more for the success of the team than any other captain Ohio ever had.

*Right.* In the football season just ended Merrill did more for the success of the team than any other captain Ohio ever had.

*Revise.* I enjoyed the freshman year with its essays and themes, since it proved to be a subject which I did not find difficult.

**362. In the formula *one of the most ... if not the most ...* put the noun in the first element of the formula.**

*Wrong.* It was one of the slowest if not the slowest game ever played on the Oval.

*Right.* It was one of the slowest games, if not the slowest, ever played on the Oval.

*Revise.* As a statesman he deserves to rank as one of the most, if not the most, contemptible figures in our history.

**363. Phrase the subject so that it exactly fits the predication required by the verb.**

*Wrong.* Mr. Swinnerton's novel, *Nocturne*, takes place in one night.

*Right.* The action in Mr. Swinnerton's novel, *Nocturne*, takes place in one night.

*Revise.* The character of Mr. Pickwick is a funny creature.

**364. Use the precise verb which is idiomatically required to predicate the subject.**

*Wrong.* Only one hour of relaxation existed for the noon meal.

*Right.* Only one hour of relaxation was allowed for the noon meal.

*Revise.* The freshman lecture last week consisted of four speakers.

**365. Use the idiomatic preposition required after the noun.**

*Wrong.* I went to the library in search for material.

*Right.* I went to the library in search of material.

*Revise.* His personality is one of the greatest factors for his success.

**366. Use different prepositions after nouns, adjectives, or verbs which idiomatically require different prepositions.**

*Wrong.* Am I included or excluded from this list?

*Right.* Am I included in or excluded from this list?

*Revise.* American literature is dependent or at least derived from English literature.

**367. Use a more idiomatic construction.**

*Wrong.* I have often had the desire of some day taking a vacation into the Rocky Mountains of the West.

*Right.* I have often wanted some time to spend a vacation among the Rocky Mountains in the West.

*Revise.* Carrie Stevens from Wilton passed three days visiting the parental home last week.

*Revise.* I spoke with him for something more than ten minutes.

**368. Use a less awkward construction.**

*Wrong.* Dr. Otto's automobile was badly damaged in the collision, but Mrs. Otto, driving, was unhurt, fortunately.

*Right.* Dr. Otto's automobile was badly damaged in the collision, but Mrs. Otto, who was driving, was fortunately unhurt.

*Revise.* During my senior year I had some experience in dramatics by taking part in the class play.

**369. Use a predicated noun rather than a predicated clause beginning with when or where.**

*Wrong.* A B.A. is where you are graduated in a liberal arts course.

*Right.* A B.A. is a degree given to graduates of a liberal arts course.

*Revise.* Golf is where you try to get the ball into the hole in the fewest possible number of strokes.

**370. Use that to introduce a predicated clause of reason.**

*Wrong.* The reason I have not read more is due to the fact that I have had no time.

*Right.* The reason I have not read more is that I have had no time.

*Revise.* My reason for reading this book was because I had previously seen the same story in the movies.

**371. Use the formula *the fact that ...* to introduce a clause of reason used as the subject.**

*Wrong.* Since you insist forces me to yield.

*Right.* The fact that you insist forces me to yield.

*Revise.* Because he looked so weak made me offer him a ride.

**372. Use *due to*, *owing to*, and *caused by* only as adjectives, obviously modifying a noun. ([See 418.](#))**

*Wrong.* This question is very difficult to answer due to the small amount of information available.

*Right.* The difficulty about answering this question is caused by the scarcity of information available.

*Right.* This question is very difficult to answer because little information is available.

*Revise.* Owing to the high wind Porter's punts in the second half averaged only twenty-eight yards.

**373. Use *because of* and *on account of* only as prepositions to introduce adverbial phrases attached to verbs.**

*Wrong.* Purdue's victory was because of the wet field.

*Right.* Purdue won because of the wet field.

*Right.* Purdue's victory was due to the wet field.

*Revise.* His kindness to me was on account of his friendship for my father.

**374. Attach a modifying word, phrase, or clause directly to the modified element without an intervening *and* or *but*. *And* or *but* should be used to join only co-ordinate elements.**

*Wrong.* The village priests were of a lower class and lived like peasants, and preaching only to the peasants.

*Right.* The village priests were of a lower class and lived like peasants, preaching only to the peasants.

*Revise.* The study of musical appreciation is very interesting, and especially when one begins to find out how little he knows about it.

**375. Discard completely any part of a sentence which has nothing to do with your thought.**

*Wrong.* We arrived in Boston before noon, and the corn was fully six inches high.

*Right.* We arrived in Boston before noon.

*Revise.* Hugh Walpole is an Englishman, but Poe wrote The Raven.

**376. Discard a redundant *that*.**

*Wrong.* I really think that upon investigation that we are shown the shallowness of the objections.

*Right.* I really think that upon investigation we are shown the shallowness of the objections.

*Revise.* I knew that if I did not read some of my outside readings before Christmas that I probably should not be up with my work in time to pass the course.

**377. Change the present participial phrase into a parallel verb or into a parallel clause if the time of action of the participle differs from that of the main verb.**

*Wrong.* Leaving home before breakfast, we arrived at our destination in time for dinner.

*Right.* We left home before breakfast and arrived at our destination in time for dinner.

*Revise.* He is thirty-six, being born in 1887.



**378. Put the noun into an *of* phrase, not into the possessive case, when the noun is the object of the verbal idea in a verbal noun in *-ing*.**

*Wrong.* Lincoln's shooting is one of the most tragic events in American history.

*Right.* The shooting of Lincoln is one of the most tragic events in American history.

*Revise.* One-eyed Pete's converting firmly established the new minister in the eyes of the whole community.

**379. Use an *of* phrase after the abstract verbal noun in *-ing*.**

*Wrong.* The legislators viewed protection only as a policy for the fostering industry.

*Right.* The legislators viewed protection only as a policy for the fostering of industry.

*Revise.* The giving examinations is overdone here.

**380. Two unconnected main clauses must be punctuated as two sentences, or must be joined with a conjunction, or one clause must be made subordinate.**

*Wrong.* The fireless cooker that I made consisted of an outer wooden box which contained a fairly good-sized metal pail, the box was large enough to allow for at least five inches of packing.

*Right.* The fireless cooker that I made consisted of an outer wooden box which contained a fairly good-sized metal pail. The box was large enough to allow for at least five inches of packing.

*Wrong.* Nine months of the year I went to school the other three I worked at home on the farm.

*Right.* Nine months of the year I went to school and the other three I worked at home on the farm.

*Wrong.* Next, you apply one coat of paint it can be put on rather thick as you have to rub most of it off later.

*Right.* Next, you apply one coat of paint, which can be put on rather thick, as you have to rub most of it off later.

*Revise.* The senior English class is required to do some work in dramatics, this is done by giving the annual class play.

**381. Join co-ordinate elements with *and*; the word *also* is an adverb, not a conjunction.**

*Wrong.* The Navajoes have large herds of cattle, also many fine horses.

*Right.* The Navajoes have large herds of cattle and many fine horses.

*Revise.* The pitcher made a home run, also two singles.

**382. Join co-ordinate main clauses with a conjunction, *and*, *but*, *for*, *or* or *nor*; or make one clause subordinate. Such words as *so*, *then*, *therefore*, and *also* are not conjunctions.**

*Wrong.* I have no favorite kinds of books, however, I do read a great deal.

*Right.* I have no favorite kinds of books, but I do read a great deal.

*Wrong.* I had to run to supper both nights so I decided I would quit.

*Right.* After I had had to run to supper both nights I decided I would quit.

*Revise.* Before school and on Saturdays I worked either in a restaurant or in a clothing store, so my reading has been limited for the last two years.

**383. Place similar modifiers of the same word together.**

*Wrong.* We saw an old house painted white.

*Right.* We saw an old white house.

*Revise.* He had a stern face, forbidding and ugly.

**384. Use only one negative in a clause.**

*Wrong.* You haven't seen nothing yet.

*Right.* You have seen nothing yet.

*Right.* You haven't seen anything yet.

*Revise.* She had not gone no farther than the post office when she heard a shot.

**385. Use *or* as a conjunction—not *nor*—when the first of the connected elements carries a negative.**

*Wrong.* Some seeds do not need to be very deep in the ground nor very far apart.

*Right.* Some seeds do not need to be very deep in the ground or very far apart.

*Revise.* A favorite son is not necessarily known throughout the whole country, nor even in the neighboring states.

**386. Omit the negative as a supposed reinforcer of *hardly*, *scarcely*, *only*, and *but*.**

*Wrong.* I can't scarcely realize it yet.

*Right.* I can scarcely realize it yet.

*Revise.* I do not like but two kinds of reading matter: novels and short stories.

**387. Use an adverb—not an adjective—to modify a verb, an adjective, or another adverb. Adverbs formed from adjectives end in *-ly*.**

*Wrong.* I worked steady all vacation.

*Right.* I worked steadily all vacation.

*Revise.* I never expect to become a real proficient student in this subject.

**388. Predicated adjectives are used correctly after the verbs *is*, *are*, *was*, *were*, *become*, *seem*, *feel*, *appear*, *look*, *sound*, *taste*, *smell*, *stand*, and *ring* when the adjective characterizes the subject and not the action.**

*Wrong.* This orange tastes sweetly.

*Right.* This orange tastes sweet.

*Revise.* His speech rings falsely.

**389. Relative pronouns** *who, which, that*, are correctly used as follows:  
*who* if the antecedent is a person; *which* if the antecedent is an animal or a thing; *that* if the antecedent is a person, an animal, or a thing.

*Wrong.* I once worked for a farmer which worked from sunrise to sunset.

*Right.* I once worked for a farmer who worked from sunrise to sunset.

*Revise.* I have a dog who is almost as intelligent as a man.

## PRACTICE

1. Them and us were not invited. (300)
2. Whom do you think ought to go? (301)
3. As to whom is best qualified, consult the dean. (302)
4. It was never them. (303)
5. Who is going, him and her? (304)
6. He made me as strong as they. (305)
7. How could you consider Mary going? (306)
8. He is one of art's greatest contributors. (307)
9. The greatest duty lies toward the parents of the boy or girl who they send to college. (308)
10. Who did you think her to be? (309)
11. I thought the person to have been he. (310)
12. What about these sort of seeds? (311)
13. When one goes back to work they feel like accomplishing something. (312)

14. His explanations are very much in detail but does not hit the mark. (313)

15. If either are late to class, both receive a setback. (314)

16. Scraping and varnishing is necessary in this case. (315)

17. He thinks neither Byron nor Shelley are great poets. (316)

18. A number has already gathered about the jail. (317)

19. The lining of blankets keep the cold air out. (318)

20. There is too many open windows in the house. (319)

21. The football team, in addition to as many graduate players as can be reached, are invited. (320)

22. Neither Frank nor the Holliwells knows her. (321)

23. Everybody who were there was pleased. (322)

24. The fruit I like best are strawberries. (323)

25. Robert don't read anything. (324)

26. I wonder what he has drank. (325)

27. He had ought to go. (326)

28. I raised up and shouted at them either to set down or lay down; it didn't matter which they did. (327)

29. I will never forget the pleasant time we had at graduation. (328)

30. They should have gone, but it rained. (329)

31. Shall he be able to come? (330)

32. I shall speak to him about it; I insist upon it. (331)

33. He told me time after time and would insist that Percival had told the whole truth. (332)

34. He said the sun was 93,000,000 miles from the earth. (333)

35. I seldom remember the name of the book or of the author until I would see the book again. (334)

36. She wanted me to have gone before you came. (335)

37. Vanadium steel is used to make many parts of the Ford car which were made of various other kinds. (336)

38. If she was able to go, we should have a good time. (337)

39. It would of been better if the paint had dried slowly. (338)

40. They hadn't ought to have tried that. (339)

41. The varsity basketball outlook is much brighter than was the case for football. Six letter men on the squad, four other candidates of outstanding ability, and a coach who says that he will stop at nothing short of a championship. (340)

42. They were a wonderful six weeks. Just full of happenings of all kinds. (341)

43. In the first year ancient history is taken up once or twice a week. The rest of the time being devoted to the study of rhetoric and composition. (342)

44. I arrived home late in the afternoon. After I had been riding an hour and a half. (343)

45. In the East, Boston, New York, Brooklyn, and Philadelphia. In the West, Chicago, St. Louis, Cincinnati, and Pittsburgh make up the league. (344)

46. Frightened nearly to death, my friend ran into the house. And hid there for a long time before she was willing even to look out the window. (345)

47. The condition that arose, I was unable to meet my obligation. (346)

48. Up in the mountains there would be very few people to bother you, and would thus enable you to spend many hours alone. (347)

49. Dancing was the next on the program. (348)

50. This historical event has had a great deal to do with the books I have read and also many other students and persons of my age. (349)

51. It was dark and no other possible way to get there. (350)

52. We heard something exciting was sure to happen before the night was over. (351)

53. The next time over, the corn is plowed in the opposite direction from which it was planted. (352)

54. Barnes is as good a hitter and a much more consistent one than anyone else on the team. (353)

55. He was very surprised to see us. (354)

56. What you or he thinks makes no difference here. (355)

57. If you or he is going, it is time to start now. (356)

58. The science building is three stories high and constructed of brick. (357)

59. Drinking I have always avoided and always will. (358)

60. I went, while my father objected. (359)

61. More votes were cast than there were voters, and a new election was ordered. (360)

62. For instance, one theater we were in, everything inside of it was white. (361)

63. One of the saddest if not the saddest sight I ever saw met my eyes when I opened the door. (362)

64. Shiloh was a crucial moment in the Civil War. (363)

65. The story was made up of the hills of Hingham. (364)

66. Fraternities were not included with my thoughts of college. (365)

67. The demand and popularity of the gladiatorial games resulted in a number of uprisings against the government. (366)

68. I like reading books, but I enjoy even more to see a good play. (367)

69. The honors for high scoring for the afternoon spent in playing bridge were awarded to Mary Devoe. (368)

70. Justice is where each man gets his deserts. (369)

71. The reason I have for liking it was because of the way the part of Portia was played. (370)

72. Because you are ignorant is no excuse in the eyes of the law. (371)

73. Due to these facts, my reading was neglected. (372)

74. The size of my feet is because of what happened one summer when I was a bell hop. (373)

75. The observer turns to the east, and looking down a short residential street which leads to a well-kept cemetery. (374)

76. They say that fools' names as well as faces are often seen in public places, but I prefer prose to poetry. (375)

77. I felt that of all the courses I ever took that the one in civics did the most for me. (376)

78. Parading up Jefferson street in the morning, we had a record-breaking crowd for the evening performance. (377)

79. Chicago's burning proved to be the making of the middle western metropolis. (378)

80. The constant offering excuses enraged me. (379)

81. Every morning except one I have either military drill or physical training, these serve to break the monotony of being cooped up in a class room the rest of the time. (380)

82. I also like scout books and detective stories, also a good love story once in a while. (381)

83. We stayed a few days in Boston and a day in Chicago, then we arrived at our destination on a rainy Monday morning two hours before breakfast time. (382)

84. Strong is he and brave. (383)

85. I wouldn't take no insolence from him. (384)

86. The vassal had to swear that he would not injure his lord nor betray his secrets. (385)

87. I don't hardly see what else I could have done. (386)

88. He does not go so deep into details as to bore his students. (387)

89. The new bell sounds harshly. (388)



90. Among the eight instructors which I have are two which I abhor.  
(389)

## CHAPTER VIII

### SENTENCE CLEARNESS

Sentences exist for the purpose of conveying thought from one mind to another. The manner of their expression must, therefore, be such that the thought expressed is obvious and unmistakable. Otherwise, sentences not only fail of their purpose but often lead to confusion, to misunderstanding, and even to disaster. The quality which renders their meaning obvious and unmistakable is called clearness.

**400. Definite pronouns (*he, she, it, this, that, who, which*) must have obvious antecedents.**

*Insufficient.* They say that the timber supply in the United States will soon be exhausted.

*Better.* Forest experts say that the timber supply in the United States will soon be exhausted.

*Revise.* Yesterday I saw Mr. Jonathan Oldcastle. She has just returned from Europe, you know.

**401. Make an ambiguous pronoun clear by placing it nearer its antecedent.**

*Confusing.* Father told us of a meadow near his old home, which was now under water.

*Unmistakable.* Father told us that near his old home there used to be a meadow which is now under water.

*Revise.* In order to succeed at football one must be willing to live up to all the rules of training, to refrain from smoking, to shun society, and to put one's whole soul into it.

**402. Change indirect discourse to direct discourse to make an antecedent obvious.**

*Equivocal.* Clark told Andrews he had made an error.

*Clear.* Clark said, “Andrews, you made an error.”

*Revise.* George, talking with Bill, said that he ought to be ashamed of himself.

**403. Never designate the antecedent of a pronoun by repeating it within parentheses.**

*Wrong.* John told Tom that he (John) had not made the team.

*Right.* John said to Tom, “I have not made the team.”

*Revise.* John told Tom that he (Tom) had not made the team.

**404. Repeat a distant noun or supply a new one rather than use an obscure pronoun.**

*Not good.* I felt sure that the parade would not be ready to start for an hour yet, as there were no soldiers about, and it was only one o’clock; so I decided to walk out toward the edge of town, taking care, however, to remain upon the street along which I knew it would pass.

*Better.* I felt sure that the parade would not be ready to start for an hour yet, as there were no soldiers about, and it was only one o’clock; so I decided to walk out toward the edge of town, taking care, however, to remain upon the street along which I knew the parade would pass.

*Revise.* The men in my company who had dissipated before entering the army found, during the long marches necessary in the Argonne Forest, that it was hard to keep up with it.

**405. Repeat the noun rather than use a pronoun that refers to an unemphatic antecedent.**

*Unimpressive.* Yesterday I saw Mrs. Hamlin in a new car designed by the Fisher company. Almost all cars designed by them are distinctive.

*Better.* Yesterday I saw Mrs. Hamlin in a new car designed by the Fisher company. Almost all cars designed by that company are distinctive.

*Revise.* Silos made of concrete are of greater value than any other kind because they last longer. This is easy to use and is cheaper in the end than any other material.

**406. Place adverbs like *only, almost, ever, nearly, just, hardly, scarcely, merely, quite* next to and usually before the words they modify.**

*Misleading.* He would only lend me five dollars.

*Accurate.* He would lend me only five dollars.

*Revise.* I don't ever want to see him again.

**407. Place negatives before the words they modify.**

*Untaught.* Everybody has not read the Bible.

*Better.* Not everybody has read the Bible.

*Revise.* All men were not born to be hanged.

**408. Use correlative conjunctions to connect only co-ordinate expressions.**

*Wrong.* I knew I would be compelled either to salute him or he would have me put in the guard house.

*Right.* I knew I would be compelled either to salute him or to spend a week in the guard house.

*Revise.* It was not only necessary for me to save all the money I could, but I knew I should have to earn more than I had ever earned before.

**409. Place correlative conjunctions as close as possible to the expressions they connect.**

*Faulty.* He was not only an expert marksman but he also was a skilled horseman.

*Improved.* He was not only an expert marksman but also a skilled horseman.

*Revise.* Military training both teaches a man to think quickly and to command others.

**410. Place every subordinate clause so that its relation to the main clause is immediately evident.**

*Uncertain.* He knew when the time came what he would do.

*Certain.* When the time came he knew what he would do.

*Revise.* Someone I knew would come in.

**411. Place relative clauses immediately after their antecedents.**

*Doubtful.* A man came up and spoke to my brother whom I had never seen before.

*Plain.* A man whom I had never seen before came up and spoke to my brother.

*Revise.* The ship flew a strange flag that came in yesterday.

**412. Place subordinate clauses so that their verbs cannot be confused with the verbs of main clauses.**

*Absurd.* The horse snorted as Jackson spoke and kicked up his heels.

*Correct.* As Jackson spoke, the horse snorted and kicked up his heels.

*Revise.* The wind stormed across the desert where the corpse lay and whistled.

**413. Place every modifying phrase so that the expression it modifies is unmistakable.**

*Misleading.* The captain says that if your rifles are not clean day after tomorrow he will put every one of you in the guard house.

*Clear.* The captain says that if day after tomorrow your rifles are not clean he will put every one of you in the guard house.

*Revise.* When he took his seat much to his chagrin the lights went out.

**414. Place co-ordinate modifiers one after another.**

*Halting.* Even though he had never seen you before, he would let you know who he was if he liked your appearance.

*Secure.* Even though he had never seen you before, if he liked your appearance he would let you know who he was.

*Revise.* If Friday is a holiday, I shall drive home if the roads are good.

**415. Make a participial phrase modify the noun or pronoun which it ought obviously to modify; or change the construction.**

*Ludicrous.* Standing upon the dome of Old Capitol, Iowa avenue presents an unusual view.

*Better.* Standing upon the dome of Old Capitol, one gets an unusual view of Iowa avenue.

*Better.* If one stands upon the dome of Old Capitol, one gets an unusual view of Iowa avenue.

*Revise.* Coming out on the train Pike's Peak is seen.

**416. Change a participle preceded by *thus* into a clause if the participle cannot logically modify the subject of the preceding verb.**

*Wrong.* She had to wait until everybody else in the room was served, thus causing her to be late.

*Right.* She had to wait until everybody else in the room was served, and the delay caused her to be late.

*Revise.* The bridges were all down between Storm Lake and Altoona, thus making all the trains late.

**417. Make a participle preceded by a conjunction agree with the noun to which it obviously belongs; or change the construction.**

*Ridiculous.* Tuesday, when wearing my new hat, a rainstorm came up and ruined it.

*Correct.* Tuesday, when I was wearing my new hat, a rainstorm came up and ruined it.

*Revise.* While eating my supper last night, one of the calves got out and ran into the corn field.

**418. A phrase beginning with the adjective *due* can refer only to a noun.**  
**([See 372.](#))**

*Wrong.* He was ill, due to overeating.

*Right.* His illness was due to overeating.

*Revise.* The train stopped, due to boiler trouble.

**419. Make a gerund prepositional phrase modify the noun or pronoun which it ought obviously to modify; or change the construction.**

*Ludicrous.* In speaking to Sparks yesterday, he told me that the team was in excellent condition.

*Clear.* In speaking to Sparks yesterday, I learned that the team was in excellent condition.

*Revise.* In trying to show Helen how to start her motor, she almost ran over me.

**420. In parallel subordinate clauses repeat the subordinating conjunction with each clause after the first.**

*Unequal.* She had heard that her mother had died suddenly after a short but violent illness, and her father had struck oil.

*Accurate.* She had heard that her mother had died suddenly after a short but violent illness, and that her father had struck oil.

*Revise.* Although the water rose steadily during the spring thaw, and the dam was on the point of giving way under the pressure, the engineer obstinately insisted that there was no danger.

**421. Repeat auxiliary verb forms with their principals.**

*Improper co-ordination.* We shall have to leave town and need an automobile.

*Improved.* We shall have to leave town and shall need an automobile.

*Revise.* A quarterback must see where the hole in the line is and take advantage of it.

**422. Repeat the *to* before each infinitive in a series.**

*Not co-ordinate.* He came to see the house, bargain for it, and buy it if terms could be agreed upon.

*Co-ordinate.* He came to see the house, to bargain for it, and to buy it if terms could be agreed upon.

*Revise.* Not only was it necessary for us to read the book, remember what was in it, and be able to recite upon it, but also write a paper upon it, and read the paper before the class.

**423. Repeat the preposition with each object.**

*Obscure.* She went to Chicago and the capital of the state.

*Better.* She went to Chicago and to the capital of the state.

*Revise.* The positions were offered to soldiers, athletes, and virile men generally.

**424. Repeat the article with each noun in a series.**

*Confusing.* They needed a minister, doctor, and lawyer at once.

*Clear.* They needed a minister, a doctor, and a lawyer at once.

*Revise.* I met the merchant and postmaster of the little town as well as the sheriff and justice of the peace.

**425. Repeat the possessive with each noun in a series.**

*Bad.* I asked her the names of her sister and puppy.

*Better.* I asked her the names of her sister and of her puppy.

*Revise.* He watched his horse, cow, and pig break through into the wheat.

**426. Give the same structure only to ideas similar in thought.**



*Misleading.* Golf is a game that requires skill, poise, good temper, and clubs that exactly suit you.

*Better.* Golf is a game that requires skill, poise, and good temper. These qualities, however, will avail little unless one has clubs that exactly suit him.

*Revise.* The new hospital was erected to the memory of John Shuler and for the benefit of crippled children.

**427. After a long or involved series, use a summarizing word before continuing the sentence.**

*Inadequate.* To live uprightly, to be amiable always, and to be considerate of others even to the point of inconvenience are the essentials of gentleness.

*Better.* To live uprightly, to be amiable always, and to be considerate of others even to the point of inconvenience—these are the essentials of gentleness.

*Revise.* O wise and upright judge, O learned in the law, O guide, philosopher, and friend, be my rock and refuge.

**428. Use *and* to connect only those expressions which are in the same construction. ([See 374.](#))**

*Bad.* We then studied chemistry, a subject much more interesting than history, and which I enjoyed thoroughly.

*Better.* We then studied chemistry, a subject much more interesting than history, and one which I enjoyed thoroughly.

*Revise.* Jacob Sturm was a man of much wealth, and who came to this country twenty years ago.

**429. Use *but* to connect only those expressions which are in the same construction.**

*Bad.* I started into high school resolved to make the most of my opportunities, but in no long time deciding to have all the fun I could.

*Better.* I started into high school resolved to make the most of my opportunities, but in no long time I decided to have all the fun I could.

*Revise.* The colonel issued an order about mounts, but which nobody could understand.

**430. After a comparative degree, exclude the subject of comparison from the class with which it is compared.**

*Wrong.* Platinum is more valuable than any metal.

*Right.* Platinum is more valuable than any other metal.

*Revise.* Morvich was swifter than any racehorse of his day.

**431. After a superlative degree, include the subject of comparison within the class with which it is compared.**

*Wrong.* Shakespeare is the greatest of any other poet.

*Right.* Shakespeare is the greatest of all poets.

*Revise.* A slave is the most miserable of all other men.

**432. Avoid an inconsistent change of person within the sentence.**

*Wrong.* You can lead a horse to water, but nobody can make him drink.

*Right.* You can lead a horse to water, but you cannot make him drink.

*Revise.* I have done the best I could, and I do not think a person should be required to do more.

**433. Avoid an inconsistent change of number within the sentence.**

*Wrong.* Tillie, Margaret, and Ann each took their seats.

*Right.* Tillie, Margaret, and Ann each took her seat.

*Revise.* Everybody should save their money while they are young.

**434. Avoid an inconsistent change of tense within the sentence.**

*Wrong.* As soon as the train came in, he hurries home.

*Right.* As soon as the train came in, he hurried home.

*Revise.* No matter what he tries, things never came out as he expected them to.

**435. Avoid an inconsistent change of mood within the sentence.**

*Wrong.* Unless it is too hard and take too much time I can finish by noon.

*Right.* Unless it is too hard and takes too much time I can finish by noon.

*Revise.* Sand is all right in the back yard, but keep it out of the front yard.

**436. Avoid an inconsistent change of voice within the sentence.**

*Wrong.* The troops were taken up in trucks but came back on the train.

*Right.* The troops went up in trucks but came back on the train.

*Revise.* A month ago I was listened to with all courtesy, but now not even a dog will listen.

## **PRACTICE**

1. The poppy can be raised in American gardens without danger of its becoming a menace as a weed, which makes its cultivation possible as a reminder of the soldiers who lie in Flanders Field. (400)

2. We can use this truck to move freight from the warehouse to the store whenever we need it. (401)

3. Mary told Leona her costume was perfectly becoming. (402)

4. Mrs. Fiske said to Miss Anglin that she (Miss Anglin) was the greatest actress in the world. (403)

5. Students who come to college merely to have a good time or because they have nothing else to do, and those who come without any deep seated desire for knowledge for its own sake should be denied the right to enter it. (404)

6. The University of Iowa is located part on one side of the Iowa River and part on the other. Many students, when the weather is good, paddle canoes upon it. (405)

7. I hardly knew anybody. (406)

8. Everyone is not more to be pitied than scorned. (407)

9. I felt that I must either make them a cake or that they would think me stingy. (408)

10. Roque is a game that is neither too easy nor is it without excitement. (409)

11. Nothing he said is worth while. (410)

12. We cleared away what the cyclone had left of the house, which had stormed through the valley during the night. (411)

13. The fire spread when we entered the village and destroyed everything. (412)

14. When she let him in much to his embarrassment she smiled broadly. (413)

15. At night she liked to walk out in the rain. (414)

16. Swimming around a bend in the river, the hospital is seen. (415)

17. I mistook her for an acquaintance, thus causing embarrassment. (416)

18. When climbing a wire fence, his shotgun went off. (417)

19. He became rich, due to oil in Mexico. (418)

20. In talking to Henry this morning, he said that he had been ill. (419)

21. He told me that his brother was an engineer and he would look into the matter. (420)

22. She would have had a great deal of trouble and, no doubt, failed in the end if we had not happened to come along. (421)

23. They learned to read French, ride horseback, and fence before they were graduated. (422)

24. There was no room for weaklings, invalids, or the disaffected. (423)

25. I was forced to refuse the invitation of the secretary and treasurer.  
(424)

26. Johnson knew his half brother, nephew, and cousin would be there.  
(425)

27. The regiment was raised for the honor of Johnson county and to drive the Spaniard out of Cuba. (426)

28. To live, to learn, to die is the sum total of existence. (427)

29. His uncle had an old car and which he used to drive to Solon. (428)

30. The instructor made an assignment but which everybody thought was too hard. (429)

31. Solomon was wiser than any man. (430)

32. Michael Angelo was the greatest of all other painters. (431)

33. Try as you may, one cannot do it. (432)

34. Everybody should save their money while they are young. (433)

35. He will have learned better by Sunday unless he never tried it again.  
(434)

36. Military training is all right for a young man, but don't ask me to take any. (435)

37. Yesterday he was seen by at least ten people, and I myself saw him today. (436)

## CHAPTER IX

### SENTENCE VIGOR

Good sentences are characterized by correctness and clearness, but the best sentences possess a third quality. Effective sentences must entertain, persuade, or convince. To do these things, they must be graceful, vivid, forceful, and emphatic presentations of the writer's ideas. The quality which makes correct and clear sentences effective is called vigor.

#### **500. To emphasize pointedly, place material in a sentence by itself.**

*Unemphatic.* The city council is determined to stop jaywalking at the east entrance of the campus, and to attain this end has adopted a plan that calls for restricting pedestrians to clearly marked lanes that cross Clinton street at right angles.

*Emphatic.* The city council is determined to stop jaywalking at the east entrance to the campus. To attain this end, the council has adopted a plan that calls for restricting pedestrians to clearly marked lanes that cross Clinton street at right angles.

*Revise.* I used to think that sleeping accommodations at fraternity houses were inadequate, but I don't now.

#### **501. Divide a sentence that seems too long.**

*Repellant.* The collections at the museum, which is the most important in the world, are in two divisions, one for the public and the other for the use of specialists, some of whom come from great distances to avail themselves of the unequalled collections set apart for their use.

*Attractive.* The collections at the museum, which is the most important in the world, are in two divisions, one for the public and the other for the use of specialists. Some specialists come from great distances to avail themselves of the unequalled collections set apart for their use.

*Revise.* That there will be no tolerance of laxity on the part of the freshmen concerning the observance of this decree was assured by the strong language of the order, which first pointed out that the wearing of the green cap by first year men was a college tradition and must be upheld, then explained that the wearing of the cap was left to the honor of every freshman, who was expected to purchase one and use it according to the rules of the past two years, which state that the cap must be worn every day until six o'clock at night, when it may be changed for the more common headgear.

#### **502. Condense wordy sentences.**

*Meandering.* At a recent meeting of the men's glee club, it was decided to increase the membership of the organization from thirty-two men to forty men.

*Succinct.* The men's glee club recently decided to increase its membership from thirty-two to forty.

*Revise.* The names of the candidates for class offices were announced Wednesday by the election committee. There are thirty-six candidates for office.

#### **503. Consolidate two or more short, jerky sentences into one smooth sentence.**

*Jerky.* The annual interfraternity pajama race was run on Sheridan road Monday night. The event took place at eleven o'clock. It was hotly contested by five fraternities. The Sig Alphas won a shivering victory.

*Smooth.* The Sig Alphas won a shivering victory on Sheridan road at eleven o'clock Monday night, when they defeated four rival teams in the annual interfraternity pajama race.

*Revise.* The natives boil the chopped leaves to a syrup. This is poured into a monkey skin. The liquid is then allowed to cool and harden.

#### **504. Vary the structure of successive sentences.**

*Monotonous.* Around the sides of the armory on the floor were booths separated by curtains. In each one of the booths was suspended a small red incandescent light. Around the hall at various places were jars containing burning incense.

*Pleasing.* Around the sides of the armory on the floor were booths separated by curtains. A small red incandescent light was suspended in each booth. Incense burned in jars at various places around the hall.

*Revise.* The oldest book in the university library, to the best knowledge of the librarians, was printed in 1511. The book was written by Johannes von Kaiserberg Geiler, a preacher of the reformation who was born about the middle of the fifteenth century. This old work is entitled *Navicula Sive Speculum Fatuorum*, which translated means, *The Ship or Mirror of Fools*. It is written in Latin and contains many curious and interesting wood cuts. The book is made up largely of sermons.

#### **505. Begin successive sentences with different words.**

*Dreary.* D is the minimum standard for a passing grade. D students compose approximately the lowest twenty-five per cent of every class. D work is that work which is not up to average, and yet is clearly above failure.

*Pleasing.* D is the minimum standard for a passing grade. Students who are marked D compose approximately the lowest twenty-five per cent of every class. The grade D means that a student's work is not up to the average, and yet is clearly above failure.

*Revise.* The military carnival was the largest exhibition of its kind ever attempted at the college. The seats were all filled, and the crowd was kept at a high point of interest throughout the entire show. The whole program was arranged in such a manner that at no time was there a lull in the activities. The opening number was a concert by the military band. The physical training exercises which followed were of the type in which the regiment itself gives the commands and then executes them. The most spectacular feature of the program was the advance to attack.



#### **506. Vary the length of successive sentences.**

*Monotonous.* The new building being erected south of the engineering building will be occupied Monday for the first time. Partition siding has held up the work to some extent. Fifteen hundred feet of partition material is still to be laid. Painting is progressing steadily. The steam fitters' work is nearly completed. Work done after Monday will be carried on by a night shift. Some work on the halls can be done during class hours. Workmen say that the building was erected in record breaking time. It has taken less than a month to complete the job.

*Pleasing.* The new building being erected south of the engineering building will be occupied Monday for the first time. Partition siding has held up the work to some extent, and fifteen hundred feet of partition material is still to be laid. Painting is progressing steadily, and the steam fitters' work is nearly completed. Work done after Monday will be carried on by a night shift, although some work on the halls can be done during class hours. Workmen say that the building was erected in record breaking time. It has taken less than a month to complete the job.

*Revise.* The seven-hundred-word sentence used by the legislature, however, is merely an example of the prevalent tendency of people to disregard the elementary principles of composition and grammar. Everyone may have a faint recollection of having studied, at some remote period of his career, the important rules of "unity, mass, and coherence." But in actual practice one too often falls into the habit of expressing thoughts in a rambling and unconnected flow of words, with the expressions embellished by slang and colloquial terms. Individuals use many words, but they usually say little, and the small germ of thought is often hard to find.

#### **507. Turn a loose sentence into a periodic sentence.**

*Feeble.* The new engine will replace the present engine in case of necessity.

*Forceful.* In case of necessity, the new engine will replace the present engine.

*Revise.* This is not a student organization although the majority of its members are federal board students.

**508. End a sentence with a striking word.**

*Lifeless.* Bring along a team that will be able to force these boys to their utmost as no team has yet been able to do.

*Striking.* Bring along a team that will do what no other team has yet been able to do, force these boys to their utmost.

*Revise.* We should win Saturday's game whether Minot can play or not.

**509. Use climactic order in a series of words, phrases, clauses, or sentences.**

*Bungling.* I have been so often reformed, regenerated, reborn, amended, and corrected that only with difficulty can I look an honest sinner in the face.

*Brilliant.* I have been so often amended, corrected, reformed, regenerated, and reborn that only with difficulty can I look an honest sinner in the face.

*Revise.* Their clothing is not sufficient for bodily comfort and is also far from presentable.

**510. Put the most significant idea near the beginning or the end of a sentence.**

*Weak.* The first speaker on the program was Dean Willard L. Sperry, who gave a short talk.

*Strong.* Dean Willard L. Sperry opened the program with a short talk.

*Revise.* There are more than six hundred courses offered to students in the college of liberal arts.

**511. Keep closely related grammatical elements together.**

*Awkward.* Cards will be distributed from eight to eleven this morning by members of the registrar's staff at the east entrance of the natural science building to the hundreds of students who have returned during the past few days.

*Well-knit.* From eight to eleven this morning, members of the registrar's staff, stationed at the east entrance of the natural science building, will distribute cards to the hundreds of students who have returned during the past few days.

*Revise.* This will, it is hoped, help the voter to select the men and women who are real leaders on the campus.

*Revise.* I want to most emphatically state that I do not believe a Union of South America is possible.

*Revise.* Appointment of George Hanby and Walter G. Phillips to confer with the president concerning the loan that is being made by the trustees to aid worthy students in meeting their necessary college expenses was made Wednesday.

## **512. Put the main idea in the main clause.**

*Characterless.* The first talk of the series was given Tuesday morning, in which he made the point that it is man's nature to pray.

*Animated.* Tuesday morning in the first talk of the series he made the point that it is man's nature to pray.

*Revise.* He had saved \$1,500,000 when one day his office boy ushered in a man who showed him a diamond of great value.

## **513. Put a subordinate idea into a subordinate construction.**

*Ungainly.* Peet took Mead's place at halfback last night and scored two touchdowns.

*Graphic.* After taking Mead's place at halfback last night Peet scored two touchdowns.

*Revise.* Great stress will be laid upon the application of these tests in the future; the people of this country spend millions of dollars

each year in giving musical training to children who have no talent for music.

**514. Write simply.**

*Affected.* Suffice it, that I am saving the best for the last.

*Natural.* I am saving the best for the last.

*Revise.* The river is too cold for careless plunges, and death-dealing cramps and chills may lead to drownings for those who beware not the perils that lie in April waters.

**515. Avoid the use of far-fetched synonyms.**

*Silly.* Fraternities can be a great force for the good of the college and for the good of the Greek letter man.

*Natural.* Fraternities can be a great force for the good of the college and for the good of the fraternity man.

*Revise.* More interest is being shown in the manly art this year than has been shown in any past season.

**516. Be definite and particular.**

*Colorless.* Many booklets were sent to freshmen before they came to college.

*Vivid.* Fifteen hundred copies of the *Freshman Handbook* were sent during July to as many prospective freshmen.

*Revise.* Last year several fraternities were put on probation.

**517. Use parallel constructions for parallel ideas.**

*Jumbled.* The speaker compared college students in their search for an education to the processes used by a tree to gain its food.

*Clear-cut.* The speaker compared a college student in search of an education to a tree in search of food.

*Revise.* To be narrow is to be a helpless journalist.

**518. Repeat a prominent word or phrase for greater emphasis.**

*Weak.* Farsighted citizens of the town are realizing more than ever the possibility of the university's becoming one of the first universities in America, not only in enrollment but also in scholastic standing.

*Strong.* Farsighted citizens of the town are realizing more than ever the possibility of the university's becoming one of the first universities in America, first not only in enrollment but first also in scholastic standing.

*Revise.* The progress in French affairs has always been slow—sometimes too much so.

**519. Avoid the monotonous repetition of words, phrases, or even syllables.**

*Flat.* The stiff collars that are being shown for formal evening wear are the wing collars.

*Skilful.* Stiff wing collars are being shown for formal evening wear.

*Revise.* In the senior class the race for president will be a close one, as Burgess, Elwood, and Sampson are expected to run a close race.

*Revise.* The county superintendents who will gather here for the conference will in part comprise the group of participants in the huge birthday party of the college of education.

**520. Avoid tautology.**

*Uncouth.* These concerts are open to the public, and everyone is invited.

*Pithy.* These concerts are open to the public.

*Revise.* Dean Smith is a native of Ohio and was born in Central City.

*Revise.* Classes in folk dancing will start Monday morning at nine A.M.

*Revise.* The coeducation of both sexes is making remarkable headway in this country.

*Revise.* She is the widow of the late Colonel Ralph H. Robinson.

*Revise.* Let's us go.

**521. Avoid pleonasm.**

*Stupid.* As I enter on this famed profession I see the mistakes of others.

*Terse.* As I enter this famed profession I see the mistakes of others.

*Revise.* There is an average of 55,000 kilowats used monthly.

**522. Avoid the use of the same word in two senses in the same sentence, or in sentences near together.**

*Clumsy.* Because there is no school available, school will be dismissed next week.

*Graceful.* Because no building is available, school will be dismissed next week.

*Revise.* The girls may survive whacks with hockey clubs and yet not be able to stand the severe test of initiation into M. C. club.

**523. Keep the same metaphor throughout the sentence.**

*Lame.* Mrs. Mondell had the edge in the race until circumstances forced her to show her hand.

*Sprightly.* Mrs. Mondell had the game won until circumstances forced her to show her hand.

*Revise.* Pronouncements against the League of Nations suddenly lose their cloak of virile Americanism and savor only of party politics when the state department places the stamp of its approval on the Chester oil concessions.

**524. Avoid incongruous metaphors.**

*Absurd.* The two hundred freshmen took their new places after the first melee was staged.

*Picturesque.* The two hundred freshmen took their new places after the resounding blows of the first melee ceased.

*Revise.* Walter Scannell, sporting editor of the *News*, will act as referee.

**525. Sentences should sing.**

*Crude.* Such a critic fails to consider the fraternity spirit of the group—the avowed aim of the group.

*Rhythmical.* Such a critic fails to consider the avowed aim of the group, its fraternal spirit.

*Revise.* Neither is it always wrong, be it remembered.

**526. Put an epigrammatic idea into a balanced sentence.**

*Unskilful.* The essential things in life are the ones that count, and the essential thing in education is to find that.

*Adroit.* The essential thing in education is to find the essential things in life.

*Revise.* Tenure here depends not upon the quality of fur in your coat but upon the quality of your thinking apparatus.

**527. Make the most vivid verb in a sentence the predicate.**

*Dull.* He was found circling a piece of furniture in the center of the room.

*Lively.* When found he was circling a piece of furniture in the center of the room.

*Revise.* They went home, stumbling from one side of the street to the other.

**528. Use the active voice rather than the passive.**

*Spiritless.* The glucose was heated and then applied to the blindfolded freshmen.

*Stirring.* The sophomores heated the glucose and applied it to the blindfolded freshmen.

*Revise.* The article appearing in the Firing Line column last Sunday above my name was not written by me.

**529. Substitute a clause or a dependent phrase for an awkward absolute phrase.**

*Involved.* What he said about the work was favorable, he being a man who leans to censure rather than to praise.

*Straightforward.* What he said about the work was favorable, for he is a man who leans to censure rather than to praise.

*Revise.* His work having been done he stopped.

*Revise.* It being his first visit to the city, he was interested in the many large houses.

**530. Avoid successive subordinations similar in form and dependent one on another.**

*Awkward.* I have an economics instructor who is a middle-aged man who has had ten years' experience as vice-president of a bank in New York City.

*Smooth.* I have an economics instructor who is a middle-aged man with ten years' experience as vice-president of a bank in New York City.

*Revise.* He eventually tired of the life of a mere henchman of the political boss of the Sixteenth ward.

**531. Avoid successive *but* or *for* clauses.**

*Jerky.* But when I had gone about a mile I thought I could go no farther, but I kept on.

*Smooth.* When I had gone about a mile I thought I could go no farther, but I kept on.

*Revise.* I wanted to leave town, for I was disgusted with the place, for I had not made a single friend.

## **PRACTICE**

1. Football is a game for the psychologist, and recognizing this coaches in the past few years have paid an increasing amount of attention to the



mental attitude of their players. (500)

2. The freshmen gathered at Lake Austin in the afternoon to plan the bombardment of B hall, and in spite of the fact that the excitement on the campus during the early evening promised an interesting conclusion to the day's events, nothing unusual happened to break the monotony until half past two in the morning, when word was brought to the waiting sophomores that the freshmen had assembled on Brackenridge field and were preparing for the attack. (501)

3. Francis Neilson will give a talk at eleven Wednesday morning in the room of the historical society. He will talk on contemporary political and economic problems. (502)

4. The Y.M.C.A. membership contest has been finished. It extended for three weeks. Keen interest was shown by the rivals for first place. Reuben Melin won, and Clarence Koski was second. (503)

5. The programs for the hop have attractive covers of gold felt with a black "I" in the center. Ogle's ten-piece orchestra will furnish music for the dance, which will be in Varsity hall. Coach and Mrs. George D. Hanshaw and Prof. and Mrs. Oscar J. Walters will chaperon. The money cleared from the hop will buy blankets for the sixteen men who won football letters. (504)

6. It will be some time before the new plans are ready. It is not known just where the new biological building will be located. It was first proposed to place the building at the northwest corner of the campus. (505)

7. To advocate the use of good English both in speaking and in writing, does not necessarily mean that one is a stickler for all the technical rules and eccentricities of the grammarian. Although a semicolon once figured as the essential question in a noted lawsuit in Texas, a person may overlook many of the rules of punctuation and still not cause any great harm to himself or to his associates. A split infinitive may be the bane of an English instructor's life, but that error does not damn an individual to eternal perdition. The use, however, of accurate and clear English, in the larger meaning of the term, should be encouraged as a matter of efficiency as well as of refinement. (506)

8. Bauer is disgusted with the world, like many writers of his class. (507)

9. Football is a great game, there is no denying that. (508)

10. Sometimes the girls become so interested in the work that they cast aside their forceps and handle earthworms, sheep eyes, pig hearts, grubs, frogs, and starfish with their fingers. (509)

11. He said that to be a successful engineer imagination and precision are necessary. (510)

12. A number of paintings, both in oil and in water color, including works by Rembrandt, Rubens, Van Dyck, Turner, Guido Reni, and other old masters as well as several canvases by more modern painters were the gift of Mrs. Mark Swanson. (511)

13. The first issue of uniforms was made Wednesday, when 237 men were equipped. (512)

14. Twenty-five candidates for membership in the University Players were recommended by the judges at the tryouts and were later elected. (513)

15. It may be understood that the successful end of such a lengthy piece of work, which involves factors that are undreamed of by those inexperienced in such matters, is hailed by an author with joy. (514)

16. It is safe to say that a better trained group of gridiron warriors never donned the moleskins. (515)

17. Although the declamatory contest is only a few days off, very few students have entered their names with Miss Hogan. (516)

18. He agrees to furnish each child with a complete outfit and a promise to replace all lost balls. (517)

19. There is no underlying motive or problem to be solved, no lesson to be taught, or moral to be drawn from the story. (518)

20. The game with Illinois is the Homecoming game and should be one of the big games of the year. (519)

21. Dean Walter S. Anthony was present and spoke about the future of engineering education. (520)

22. The party will be in the form of a costume affair. (521)

23. Any pledge leaving college before she is initiated shall be considered released from her pledge at the end of one calendar year from the date of pledging. (522)

24. With seemingly every other subject run into the ground, fairy tales are now to receive a black eye. (523)

25. An audience of 30,000 saw the Thanksgiving Day game. (524)

26. From New Haven a menacing growl comes. (525)

27. Some institutions had a crop of traditions before this state had even a corn crop. (526)

28. The person selling the largest number of subscriptions was Mary Rowe. (527)

29. Music by Sousa's band was supplied between the halves. (528)

30. Both rear tires having been punctured, my fingers were all thumbs, it being my first race. (529)

31. He is the man that bought the house that stood on the lot that was next to ours. (530)

32. This gave the man receiving the ball better protection, but left an opening for passes, but Solon did not have a play to use. (531)

## CHAPTER X

### WORDS

New words and expressions, as well as new uses for old words, are being added to the English language daily. Likewise words and expressions once current are continually being discarded. The question that confronts any writer is, what words and expressions are now accepted as standard. In difficult cases only persistent consultation of the best dictionaries and a careful study of the practice followed by the best writers now living and by reputable publishing houses will furnish the correct answer. The practice followed by the majority of the leading writers and publishers of the present day determines good usage.

#### **600. Consult a dictionary to determine the meaning of a word.**

Be especially careful in using the following:

aggravate  
alternative  
amateur  
among  
asset  
aught  
awful  
balance  
between  
borrow  
can  
claim  
depot  
expect  
fine

learn  
locate  
mad  
mean  
nice  
outside  
over  
party  
propose  
proposition  
school  
unique

**601. Distinguish accurately between words resembling each other in form, but differing in meaning.**

affect, effect  
all ready, already  
all together, altogether  
allude, elude  
allusion, illusion  
almost, most  
beside, besides  
continual, continuous  
emigrate, immigrate  
except, accept  
healthful, healthy  
lend, loan  
loose, lose  
luxuriant, luxurious  
plentiful, plenty  
practicable, practical

principal, principle

quiet, quite

way, ways, away

**602. Use words that exactly express your thought.**

Do not be content with the first word that occurs to you. Strive for concrete and picturesque words—words that will convey an accurate and vivid image to your reader. The search for exactly the right synonym will be greatly facilitated if you will consult one of the standard books which list synonyms. Some of the good books of this sort are those compiled by Roget, Crabbe, Smith, Marsh, and Soule.

Instead of the word *say*, for instance, consider *talk, utter, claim, affirm, shout, whisper, stammer, speak, lisp, giggle, maintain, state, answer, argue, laugh, preach, reply, respond*.

*Walk* is not the only word to express locomotion under one's own power. Consider, for instance, *amble, fall, gambol, glide, leap, pace, prance, promenade, ramble, run, slink, slouch, steal, stagger, stride, stroll, stumble*.

**603. Avoid newly coined words.**

Particularly atrocious examples of newly coined words are *to burgle, to burglarize*, and *to enthuse*.

**604. Avoid using verbs as nouns and nouns as verbs unless such usage has been admitted into the standard language.**

Examples of verbs that have not yet been accepted as nouns are *combine, invite, steal, try*, and *win*.

Examples of nouns that have not yet been accepted as verbs are *suicide* and *suspicion*.

**605. Do not use slang in formal composition.**

*Bad.* "Thank you for the ride in your auto." "You bet."

*Better.* "Thank you for the ride in your automobile." "Don't mention it."

**606. Use words that harmonize with the tone of the whole composition.**

In ordinary writing avoid such words as *said, same, thereby, therein, and hereinbefore.*

*Bad.* Said rule is often broken.

*Better.* The rule just mentioned is often broken.

*Bad.* I received the watch and thank you for same.

*Better.* Thank you for the watch which has just arrived.

**607. Avoid poetical words in prose.**

Examples are *amid, anew, dwelt, ere, eve, hence, hither, morn, 'neath, o'er, oft, 'tis, thrice, 'twas, whither.*

**608. Use unaffected expressions rather than trite or hackneyed ones.**

*Avoid:* a good time was had by all; bolt from a clear sky; beggars description; beyond description; indescribable; a royal reception; checkered career; discourse sweet music; dull, sickening thud; doomed to disappointment; exception proves the rule; fair maidens; the grim reaper; hungry as bears; last but not least; method in his madness; nipped in the bud; render (a vocal solo); sought his downy couch; stood like sentinels; stage (for anything except a theatrical performance); too full for utterance; took to his heels; wended their way; where ignorance is bliss.

**609. Use simple rather than pretentious expressions.**

|               |                 |           |                 |
|---------------|-----------------|-----------|-----------------|
| <i>Prefer</i> | get up          | <i>to</i> | arise           |
|               | wife or husband | <i>to</i> | better half     |
|               | eat             | <i>to</i> | partake of      |
|               | dog             | <i>to</i> | canine          |
|               | cat             | <i>to</i> | feline          |
|               | horse           | <i>to</i> | equine          |
|               | clergyman       | <i>to</i> | divine          |
|               | give            | <i>to</i> | donate          |
|               | flowers         | <i>to</i> | floral offering |

|               |    |                                                              |
|---------------|----|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| man           | to | gentleman                                                    |
| woman         | to | lady                                                         |
| letter        | to | kind favor                                                   |
| arm or leg    | to | limb                                                         |
| funeral       | to | last sad rites or obsequies                                  |
| often         | to | oftentimes                                                   |
| body          | to | remains                                                      |
| live          | to | reside                                                       |
| house or home | to | residence                                                    |
| go to bed     | to | retire                                                       |
| friend        | to | boy friend, girl friend, gentleman friend, or<br>lady friend |

**610. Use uncontracted forms in dignified writing.**

*Conversational.* I can't and won't go.

*Dignified.* I cannot and will not go.

**611. Use *I, me, or my* rather than some form of *we* or *the writer*.**

*Insufferably modest.* In the opinion of the present writer Locke should win.

*Direct.* Locke should win.

*Direct.* I think Locke should win.

**612. Use simple personal pronouns rather than intensive or reflexive pronouns.**

*Affected.* You would confer a great favor on my wife and myself if you would come.

*Natural.* You would confer a great favor on my wife and me if you would come.

*Affected.* Myself and brother are both members of the Capen debating society.

*Natural.* My brother and I both belong to the Capen debating society.



*Affected.* These tickets will admit self and guests.

*Natural.* These tickets will admit you and your guests.

**613. Follow good usage in referring to a husband or a wife.**

*Vulgar.* You will have to see Mr. about renting the garage.

*Better.* You will have to see my husband about renting the garage.

*Vulgar.* The dinner was in honor of J. A. Smith and wife.

*Better.* The dinner was in honor of Mr. and Mrs. J. A. Smith.

*Vulgar.* Among the guests were Mrs. Capt. Johnson, Mrs. Prof. Healy,  
Mrs. Rev. Shaw, and Mrs. President Ford.

*Better.* Among the guests were Mrs. Ralph G. Johnson, Mrs. Lionel F.  
Healy, Mrs. Harry L. Shaw, and Mrs. Ferdinand L. Ford.

*Vulgar.* After John had been married two years, she left him.

*Better.* After John had been married two years, his wife left him.

**614. Avoid illiterate usage.**

**alright.** There is no such word. Use *all right*.

**and.** *And* does not mean *or*.

*Wrong.* He asks four and five dollars for a straw hat.

*Right.* He asks four or five dollars for a straw hat.

**as.** Use *because* as a causal conjunction rather than *as*.

*Bad.* I could not go to the game as I had to get the dinner.

*Better.* I could not go to the game because I had to get the dinner.

Use *so* after a negative rather than *as*.

*Bad.* He is not as bad as he is painted.

*Better.* He is not so bad as he is painted.

**as though.** *As if* is preferable to *as though*.

*Bad.* He talked as though he had a potato in his mouth.

*Better.* He talked as if he had a potato in his mouth.

**at about.** *At about* is a slovenly colloquialism. Omit *at*.

*Bad.* He left at about six o'clock.

*Better.* He left about six o'clock.

**call attention.** Attention is *directed*, not *called*.

**certainly.** Over use has made *certainly* unemphatic.

*Bad.* I will certainly be there.

*Better.* I will be there.

**data.** Plural, not singular.

**did.** *Did* is wrong if you mean *have*.

*Wrong.* I didn't see him yet.

*Right.* I haven't seen him yet.

**each other.** *Each other* applies to two persons or things; *one another* to more than two.

**extra.** *Extra* does not mean *unusually*.

**falls.** Plural, not singular.

**first-rate.** An adjective, not an adverb.

*Wrong.* You cook first-rate.

*Right.* You are a first-rate cook.

**freshmen.** The adjective is *freshman*.

**held.** *Held* should not be applied to a lecture, a meeting, or an initiation.

*Bad.* Our fraternity held initiation for eight men.

*Better.* Our fraternity initiated eight men.

*Bad.* The meeting was held in Robinson hall.

*Better.* The meeting was in Robinson hall.

**Honorable.** See *Reverend*.

**if.** Use *whether* if that is what you mean.

*Wrong.* I don't know if I can.

*Right.* I don't know whether I can.

**in.** Use *into* to express motion.

*Bad.* He went in the house.

*Better.* He went into the house.

**liable.** Use *likely* or *probably* unless referring to something undesirable.

*Bad.* He is liable to pass the course.

*Better.* It is likely that he will pass the course.

*Better.* He will probably pass the course.

**like.** Use *as* or *as if* to introduce a clause.

*Wrong.* Do it like I do.

*Right.* Do it as I do.

*Wrong.* You look like you were cold.

*Right.* You look as if you were cold.

**lit.** Use *lighted*.

**line.**

*Loose.* What line are you in?

*Exact.* What business are you in?

*Bad.* He can do anything in the line of athletics.

*Better.* He can do anything in athletics.

*Atrocious.* Would you like something in the line of music?

*Better.* Would you like some music?

**one another.** *Each other* applies to two persons or things; *one another* to more than two.

**per.** *Per* should be followed by a Latin word.

*Wrong.* His salary is \$5,000 per year.

*Right.* His salary is \$5,000 a year.

*Right.* His salary is \$5,000 *per annum*.

Use *according to* or *in accordance with* instead of *as per*.

*Wrong.* He paid me Monday as per our agreement.

*Right.* He paid me Monday in accordance with our agreement.

**per cent.**

*Wrong.* What per cent will go to college?

*Right.* What percentage will go to college?

**real.** *Real* is not a synonym for *very*.

*Wrong.* I like him real well.

*Right.* I like him very well.

**Reverend.** *Reverend* should be preceded by *the* and should be followed by *Father*, *Mr.*, *Dr.*, given name, or initials as well as by the surname. A clergyman is entitled to be called *Dr.* only when he has a degree of Doctor of Divinity.

*Wrong.* Reverend Folsom offered prayer.

*Right.* The Reverend Mr. Folsom offered prayer.

*Right.* The Reverend Haskell J. Folsom offered prayer.

*Wrong.* The Reverend Sanders presided.

*Right.* The Reverend R. E. Sanders presided.

*Wrong.* I met Reverend Barlow on the street.

*Right.* I met the Reverend Dr. Barlow on the street.

**phenomena.** Plural, not singular.

**Professor.** *Professor* is used only for teachers of full professorial rank in a recognized college or university.

*Wrong.* The new high school principal is Professor Jones.

*Right.* The new high school principal is Mr. Jones.

*Wrong.* Professor Smith's orchestra played.

*Right.* Smith's orchestra played.

**sideways.** *Sidewise* is correct.

**so.** Incorrect for *so that*.

*Wrong.* I want the money so I can go home.

*Right.* I want the money so that I can go home.

*So* should not be used alone to modify an adjective.

*Bad.* College life is so stimulating.

*Better.* College life is the most stimulating life of all.

**strata.** Plural, not singular.

**tend.** Use *attend* or *take care of* rather than *tend*.

*Bad.* I'll tend to your case, young man, after school.

*Better.* I'll attend to your case, young man, after school.

*Bad.* It is hard for me to write while tending the baby.

*Better.* It is hard for me to write while taking care of the baby.

**than, till, until.** Not synonyms for *when* after *hardly* or *scarcely*.

*Wrong.* Hardly had he fired than the burglar fell.

*Right.* Hardly had he fired when the burglar fell.

*Wrong.* She had scarcely spoken until we arrived.

*Right.* She had scarcely spoken when we arrived.

**United States.** Should be preceded by *the* when used as a noun.

*Wrong.* France and United States have always been good friends.

*Right.* France and the United States have always been good friends.

**ways.** Plural, not singular.

**while.** *While* means *during the time in which*, or *though*. It does not mean *but*.

*Good.* While I was gone the house burned.

*Good.* While what you say may be true, it will not affect my action.

*Bad.* The men sit on one side while the women sit on the other.

*Better.* The men sit on one side; the women on the other.

### **615. Use reputable words.**

**all the.**

*Wrong.* This is all the farther I will go.

*Right.* This is as far as I will go.

**A.M., P.M.** Use only after numbers, meaning the hour.

*Wrong.* We started early in the A.M.

*Right.* We started early in the morning.

**and etc.** *Etc.* is an abbreviation for *et cetera*, which means *and other things*.

*Wrong.* We bought flags, handkerchiefs, and etc.

*Right.* We bought flags, handkerchiefs, etc.

**any place.** The correct expression is *anywhere*.

**anywheres.** The correct expression is *anywhere*.

**badly.** *Badly* is not a synonym for *exceedingly* or *very much*.

*Wrong.* I wanted it badly.

*Right.* I wanted it very much.

**company.** *Guest* is a better word than *company*.

*Wrong.* We expect company for supper.

*Right.* We expect a guest for supper.

**complected.**

*Wrong.* He is light complected.

*Right.* He has a light complexion.

**considerable.** *Considerable* is not a synonym for *much* or *many*.

*Wrong.* We have had considerable trouble lately.

*Right.* We have had a great deal of trouble lately.

*Wrong.* There were considerable people there.

*Right.* There were many persons there.

**drunk.** *Drunk* is not in good usage as a noun. Use *a drunken man*.

**every place.** The correct expression is *everywhere*.

**folks.**

*Wrong.* I am going to visit the folks this week.

*Right.* I am going to visit my family this week.

*Wrong.* More than one thousand folks saw the accident.

*Right.* More than one thousand persons saw the accident.

**gent.** Use *gentleman*, or preferably *man*.

**get-up.**

*Wrong.* Did you ever see such a get-up?

*Right.* Did you ever see such a costume?

**get up.**

*Wrong.* We are getting up a straw ride for Thursday evening.

*Right.* We are planning a straw ride for Thursday evening.

**got.** To indicate possession use *have* rather than *have got*.

*Wrong.* Have you got a pencil?

*Right.* Have you a pencil?

**hear to it.**

*Wrong.* I absolutely refuse to hear to it.

*Right.* I absolutely refuse to consider it.

**human.** *Human* is not a noun.

*Wrong.* Humans are in many ways like animals.

*Right.* Men and women are in many ways like animals.

*Right.* Human beings are in many ways like animals.

**in back of.** *Behind* is better than *in back of*.

*Wrong.* We fought in back of the barn.

*Right.* We fought behind the barn.

**inside of.** Use *inside* or *within*.

*Wrong.* He went inside of the house.

*Right.* He went inside the house.

*Wrong.* Inside of ten minutes not a trace remained.

*Right.* Within ten minutes not a trace remained.

**kind of.**

*Wrong.* It was kind of cold.

*Right.* It was fairly cold.

**leave.** Use *let*.

*Wrong.* Leave go of my hat.

*Right.* Let go my hat.

*Wrong.* Leave me have it.

*Right.* Let me have it.

**lot.** Not a synonym for *many*, *much*, or *ample*.

*Wrong.* We had lots of time.

*Right.* We had ample time.

**meet with.** *With* is superfluous.

*Bad.* He met with the committee.



*Better.* He met the committee.

**military.** *Military* is not a noun.

*Wrong.* The military confiscated all coal in the town.

*Right.* The military authorities confiscated all coal in the town.

**no place.** The correct expression is *nowhere*.

**nowhere near.** The correct expression is *not nearly*.

**nowheres.** The correct expression is *nowhere*.

**of.** *Of* should never be used for *have*. ([See 338.](#))

*Wrong.* I could of won if I had of been willing to lie.

*Right.* I could have won if I had been willing to lie.

**off of.** *Off* is enough.

*Wrong.* She stepped backwards off of the car.

*Right.* She stepped backwards off the car.

**only.** *Only* is not a synonym for *but* or *except*.

*Wrong.* I would not be where I am today only for my wife.

*Right.* I would not be where I am today except for my wife.

**out loud.** The correct expression is *aloud*.

**over with.** *Over* is enough.

*Wrong.* The concert was over with at ten o'clock.

*Right.* The concert was over at ten o'clock.

**overly.** There is no such word.

*Wrong.* I think he is not overly particular.

*Right.* I think he is not very particular.

**people.** Use *persons*.

*Bad.* Thirty people applied for the position.

*Better.* Thirty persons applied for the position.

**P.M.** See A.M.

**posted.** *Posted* is not a synonym for *informed*.

*Wrong.* Keep me posted on what happens while I am gone.

*Right.* Keep me informed of what happens while I am gone.

**providing.** *Providing* is not a synonym for *if*.

*Wrong.* I can go providing it does not rain.

*Right.* I can go if it does not rain.

**put in.**

*Wrong.* I put in two years at college.

*Right.* I spent two years at college.

**put up.**

*Wrong.* He put me up for the night.

*Right.* He lodged me for the night.

**remember of.** *Remember* is enough.

*Wrong.* I do not remember of meeting him.

*Right.* I do not remember meeting him.

**shape.**

*Wrong.* He is in bad shape.

*Right.* He is ill. Or, He is in bad condition.

**show.** *Show* is not a synonym for a *theatrical performance*.

*Wrong.* It was the best show of the year.

*Right.* It was the best musical comedy of the year.

**some place.** The correct expression is *somewhere*.

**sort of.**

*Wrong.* He is sort of short for a high jumper.

*Right.* He is hardly tall enough for a high jumper.

**stop.** *Stop* is not a synonym for *stay*.

*Wrong.* We are stopping at the hotel.

*Right.* We are staying at the hotel.

**sure.**

*Wrong.* I should sure like to go.

*Right.* I should surely like to go.

*Wrong.* Sure I'll come.

*Right.* Surely I'll come. *Or*, I'll be glad to come.

**tasty.** Use *delicious* or some similar expression.

*Wrong.* That is a tasty pudding.

*Right.* That is a delicious pudding.

**through.** *Through* is not a synonym for *finished*.

*Wrong.* I was through the examination at quarter of nine.

*Right.* I finished the examination at quarter of nine.

**try and.** *Try to* is preferable to *try and*.

*Wrong.* Try and do better.

*Right.* Try to do better.

**up.** *Up* adds nothing to such verbs as *end*, *meet*, *finish*, *eat*, and *burn*.

*Wrong.* It took the firemen an hour after the house burned up to finish up their work.

*Right.* It took the firemen an hour after the house burned to finish their work.

**visit with.** *With* is superfluous.

*Wrong.* My mother is visiting with relatives.

*Right.* My mother is visiting relatives.

**where.**

*Wrong.* Did you see in the paper where the minister has resigned?

*Right.* Did you see in the paper that the minister had resigned?

**without.** *Without* is not a synonym for *unless*.

*Wrong.* Without I say so, you will not be elected.

*Right.* Unless I say so, you will not be elected.

#### **616. Use words current in present standard English.**

Avoid such antiquated words as *firstly*, *gotten*, and *proven*.

**but what.** *But that* is preferable to *but what*.

*Wrong.* I cannot see but what you are right.

*Right.* I cannot see but that you are right.

**cannot help but.**

*Wrong.* I cannot help but think he is innocent.

*Right.* I cannot help thinking he is innocent.

**different than.** Use *different from*.

*Wrong.* Mabel looks different than Alice.

*Right.* Mabel looks different from Alice.

#### **617. Use words and expressions nationally current.**

**forenoon.**

*Bad.* The forenoon session began at eight.

*Better.* The morning session began at eight.

**get.**

*Wrong.* I am sorry, but I did not get to go.

*Right.* I am sorry, but I was unable to go.

**going on.**

*Bad.* He is six years old, going on seven.

*Better.* He is nearly seven years old.

**gun.**

*Bad.* He carried a gun in his belt.

*Better.* He carried a revolver in his belt.

**like.**

*Wrong.* You say George is in Boston. How does he like?

*Right.* You say George is in Boston. How does he like it there?

**make of.**

*Bad.* When Oscar came to town all the girls made of him.

*Better.* When Oscar came to town all the girls paid him much attention.

**raise.**

*Bad.* I was raised in the South.

*Better.* I was reared in the South.

**smart.**

*Bad.* He is a smart boy.

*Better.* He is a bright boy.

**some.**

*Bad.* Father feels some better.

*Better.* Father feels somewhat better.

**stair steps.**

*Bad.* I fell down the stair steps.

*Better.* I fell down the stairs.

**stoop.**

*Bad.* Every evening we sit on the stoop.

*Better.* Every evening we sit on the porch.

**tote.**

*Bad.* He was toting a barrel of flour on his shoulder.

*Better.* He was carrying a barrel of flour on his shoulder.

**wait on.**

*Bad.* If Mr. Brown will be back within an hour I shall wait on him.

*Better.* If Mr. Brown will be back within an hour I shall wait for him.

**want.**

*Bad.* Do you want in?

*Better.* Do you want to come in?

*Bad.* I want that you should go.

*Better.* I want you to go.

**618. Use the correct form of nouns which have an abstract meaning in the singular and a concrete meaning in the plural.**

*Wrong.* His preparations for the examination were inadequate.

*Right.* His preparation for the examination was inadequate.

*Wrong.* Anyone suspected of cowardice was killed by tortures.

*Right.* Anyone suspected of cowardice was killed by torture.

## CHAPTER XI

### SPELLING

Correct spelling marks the well-educated man or woman. This simple fact constitutes the reason why one must learn to spell.

English spelling offers difficulty partly because it is somewhat archaic—that is, because pronunciation has changed since spelling became fixed by printers about three hundred years ago; partly because the English alphabet is inadequate—it has only twenty-six characters, and there are forty-two sounds in spoken English.

But however irrational may be the spelling of many English words, every student must master spelling. Nor is this a difficult task if attacked with persistence and determination. The chief obstacles are carelessness and lack of courage. Of the 450,000 words in the largest dictionaries, probably not more than one thousand are commonly misspelled by any one person—even the worst speller alive. Completely mastering a few words each day for one year, therefore, will enable any one to become a good speller.

But no short cut method has ever been discovered which will give skill to the writer who finds spelling difficult. Every separate word which he habitually misspells must be thoroughly and permanently learned by a distinct effort of the memory, aided by regular practice. Practice, in fact, is the only means of acquiring fluent and permanent control over one's pet failings. But the memorizing and the practice may well be facilitated by an intelligent attack on the problem.

Human beings remember things in different ways, or in a combination of different ways. Some remember most easily and clearly what they have carefully looked at; these are of the visualizing type. Some remember what they have heard spoken aloud; these are of the auditory type. And others remember best certain motions which their muscles have performed; these are of the motor type. It follows that some persons learn to spell most easily by looking carefully at a difficult word letter by letter or syllable by syllable; others by hearing it spelled aloud or by spelling it aloud; and still

others by writing it over and over. But of whatever type a person may be, he learns best by combining all three methods, and by assiduously practicing the last, for the only time he needs to spell is when he is writing.

The problem of spelling can be mastered by writing every word five or ten times while the writer has his eyes fixed upon the correct form and is spelling the word aloud. Practice on the same word for three successive days is almost certain to fix it for all time in the memory.

The weak speller cannot dispense with a dictionary. Asking a fellow student how to spell a word marked incorrect by an instructor is fatal, for the fellow student is often as ignorant as the questioner. Look up the misspelled word in *Webster's*, the *Standard*, or the *Century Dictionary*.

## RULES

Many misspellings fall into classes which can be covered by simple rules. Following are the most helpful of these rules.

**700. Words with a last syllable consisting of a single short accented vowel followed by a single consonant, double the consonant when adding a suffix beginning with a vowel.**

dip-p-ed

occur-r-ed

occur-r-ence

stop-p-ing

forget-t-ing

unforget-t-able

sad-d-en

forbid-d-en

tranquil-l-ity

Observe that the conditions are three:

1. Accent on the last syllable
2. Single short vowel



### 3. Single final consonant

**701. Words with a last syllable ending in a short vowel and a single consonant, but *not* accented on the last syllable, do *not* double the final consonant.**

worship-ed

level-ing

travel-er

**702. Words ending in final silent *-e* drop the *-e* before a suffix beginning with a vowel. They do NOT double the consonant.**

hope, hop-ed

fine, fin-er

dine, din-ing

crude, crud-ity

wide, wid-en

subside, subsid-ence

**703. Words ending in *-ce* or *-ge* keep the *-e* before a suffix beginning with *-a* or *-o*, to show that *-c-* or *-g-* is soft.**

change-able

peace-able

courage-ous

notice-able

advantage-ous

service-able

**704. Words with an accented double vowel, or with an accented diphthong, do NOT double a final single consonant.**

stoop-ed

loud-er

meet-ing  
roar-ing  
sweet-en  
join-ing

**705. CEI. *EI* regularly follows *c*-.**

conceive  
ceiling  
deceive  
conceit  
receive  
deceit  
perceive  
receipt

Observe also: *either, neither, leisure, seize, weird, their, counterfeit, foreign.*

**706. EI occasionally spells the sound of long *i* and of long *a*.**

height  
sleight  
weigh  
freight  
neighbor

**707. IE regularly follows all consonants except *c*-.**

believe  
pier  
field  
niece  
piece

relieve  
belief  
wield  
achieve  
pierce  
retrieve  
relief  
yield  
brief  
bier  
siege  
fiend  
grief

Observe also: *financier, friend, sieve.*

**708. Nouns ending in a vowel and -y form the plural by adding -s.**

days  
boys  
chimneys  
valleys

**709. Verbs ending in a vowel and -y form the third person singular, present indicative, by adding -s.**

lays  
enjoys  
employs

**710. Nouns ending in a consonant and -y form the plural by changing the -y to -i and adding -es.**

fly, fli-es

sky, ski-es  
lady, ladi-es

**711. Many nouns ending in *-f* or *-fe* form the plural in *-ves*.**

wolf, wolves  
self, selves  
life, lives  
half, halves  
leaf, leaves  
wife, wives  
calf, calves  
loaf, loaves  
knife, knives

**712. Some foreign nouns form the plural according to the inflectional laws of their own language.**

alumna, alumnae  
axis, axes  
datum, data  
stratum, strata  
alumnus, alumni  
parenthesis, parentheses  
formula, formulae  
phenomenon, phenomena  
analysis, analyses  
crisis, crises  
basis, bases

**713. *Don't, won't, can't, aren't, hasn't, haven't*, have the apostrophe between *n* and *t*, where a vowel has been omitted.**

**714. *It's* is the colloquial form of *it is*. The apostrophe marks the omission of *i*.**

**715. *Its, yours, hers, ours, theirs, his, whose* (possessive pronouns), do NOT have an apostrophe.**

**716.** Following is a list of words most frequently misspelled by college freshmen.

accept

accidentally

accommodate

acknowledgment

across

affects

aggravate

airplane

all right

already

altogether

amateur

analyze

apparatus

appearance

arctic

argument

athlete

athletic

balance

beginning

believing

benefited

biscuit  
Britain  
business  
busy  
calendar  
can't  
center  
certain  
changeable  
chauffeur  
choose  
clothes  
coarse  
column  
committee  
compel  
concede  
conceivable  
Connecticut  
conscience  
conscientious  
controlled  
course  
deceitful  
deferred  
definite  
descend  
describe  
desperate  
development  
dining room

disappear  
disappoint  
discipline  
dissatisfied  
dissipate  
divide  
don't  
dying  
ecstasy  
embarrass  
enemy  
envelop  
equipped  
especially  
exaggerate  
exceed  
excellent  
except  
exhaust  
existence  
familiar  
fascinate  
February  
fifth  
finally  
financier  
forfeit  
formerly  
forty  
fourth  
friend

fulfil  
generally  
good-bye  
government  
governor  
grammar  
grievous  
harass  
having  
height  
hoping  
hurriedly  
hygienic  
imaginary  
immediately  
incidentally  
inclose  
independence  
indispensable  
infinite  
inquire  
instance  
intercede  
irresistible  
its  
it's  
itself  
judgment  
knowledge  
laboratory  
laid



led  
library  
lightning  
lose  
maintenance  
Massachusetts  
mathematics  
medicine  
mischievous  
Mississippi  
misspelled  
muscle  
mysterious  
necessary  
neither  
noticeable  
occasion  
occurred  
occurrence  
o'clock  
omission  
opinion  
opportunity  
original  
paid  
parallel  
parliament  
particularly  
partner  
perceive  
perform

perhaps  
permissible  
pervade  
physical  
possession  
precede  
preferred  
preparation  
principal  
principle  
privilege  
proceed  
professor  
program  
promissory  
pronunciation  
prove  
quiet  
quite  
really  
receive  
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recommend  
reference  
repetition  
restaurant  
ridiculous  
seize  
sentence  
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shining

siege  
similar  
skilful  
speech  
stationary  
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stopped  
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strictly  
superintendent  
supersede  
sure  
surprise  
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together  
too  
tract  
tragedy  
tranquillity  
transferred  
trouble  
truly  
Tuesday  
until  
using  
usually

village

villain

weather

Wednesday

weird

welfare

whether

which

wholly

who's

whose

women

you're

## CHAPTER XII

### PUNCTUATION

Marks of punctuation are used for the purpose of making the meaning of sentences unmistakable. It is not sufficient that sentences be grammatically correct, clear, and vigorous; they must also be perfectly punctuated if their meaning is to be unmistakable. A writer must, therefore, observe the rules of punctuation if his writing is to be intelligible.

**800. Use a period (.) at the end of declarative and of imperative sentences.**

**801. Use a period after every abbreviation.**

*Right.* Mr. C. S. McIntyre of the C. R. I. and P. Ry. Co. received a ten per cent increase.

*Right.* The editors, reporters, feature writers, etc., and the printers, advertising solicitors, circulation men, etc., of the Springfield (Mass.) Republican are all able men.

**802. Never use a period at the end of an incomplete sentence element.**

*Illiterate.* After the sun had set. We went home.

*Correct.* After the sun had set, we went home.

**803. Use a question mark (?) at the end of a direct question.**

**804. Use a question mark, sparingly, to indicate doubt. In this instance the question mark should be enclosed within parentheses.**

*Right.* In the year 1596 (?) he was sent to Italy.

**805. Never use a question mark at the end of an indirect question.**

*Wrong.* I asked him what he intended to do?

*Right.* I asked him what he intended to do.

**806. Use an exclamation point (!) at the end of exclamatory expressions.**

*Right.* What a terrible experience!

**807. Use a comma (,) between co-ordinate clauses that are joined by *and* or *but* only if the subjects of the clauses are different.**

*Wrong.* He began as office boy, but in no long time he became timekeeper.

*Right.* He began as office boy but in no long time he became timekeeper.

*Wrong.* He began as office boy but in no long time they made him timekeeper.

*Right.* He began as office boy, but in no long time they made him timekeeper.

**808. Use a comma between clauses joined by the conjunction *for*.**

*Wrong.* He went into the house for his automobile needed water.

*Right.* He went into the house, for his automobile needed water.

**809. Use a comma between short co-ordinate clauses not joined by conjunctions, if the clauses are parallel in structure.**

The horse neighed, the pig grunted, the dog barked.

**810. Use a comma after a dependent clause that precedes a main clause.**

When he speaks, we all listen.

**811. Use commas to set off clauses or phrases that add merely a descriptive idea to the expression modified.**

Abraham Lincoln, who was born in a log cabin, became one of the greatest presidents.

They, reading the newspaper, did not hear me come in.

**812. Use commas between adjectives in a series if the position of the adjectives can be logically interchanged.**

Each one carried a red, white, and blue flag.

**813. Use commas between words, phrases, or clauses in a series.**

He sent me two books, a drum, and a small wagon.

Seeing the dark sky, feeling the sharp wind, and knowing that my family would be worried, I hurried home.

If he had not been ill, if the bank had not failed, and if my credit had not been exhausted, you would never have found me here.

**814. Use a comma before the *and* connecting the last two members of a series.**

*Wrong.* He ordered bread and butter, ham and eggs, cucumbers and milk.

*Right.* He ordered bread and butter, ham and eggs, cucumbers, and milk.

**815. Use a comma to separate elements which might otherwise become confused.**

*Wrong.* Not long before he had bought the horse.

*Right.* Not long before, he had bought the horse.

*Wrong.* We drove up to the house, and the motor stopped allowing us to complete the trip without disaster along the road.

*Right.* We drove up to the house, and the motor stopped, allowing us to complete the trip without disaster along the road.

*Confusing.* Which of the men to choose from among all those who applied would be a difficult matter to decide.

*Better.* Which of the men to choose from among all those who applied, would be a difficult matter to decide.

**816. Use commas to set off names in direct address.**

Here, Jim, let me do that.

**817. Use commas to set off appositives.**

Hilda Kasper, the cateress, served the luncheon.

**818. Use commas to set off geographical names which explain other geographical names.**

He lived in Birmingham, Alabama, before he came here.

**819. Use commas to set off the year as a part of a date.**

In April, 1923, he went home.

The letter was dated February 2, 1910.

**820. Use commas to set off absolute phrases.**

The soldiers having rested, Hannibal ordered the army to start.

**821. Use commas to set off mild interjections or slightly parenthetical expressions.**

It was, alas, too late.

Yes, I shall be glad to go.

No, I am sure that is not correct.

It was, therefore, his duty to accept.

I never met him, you know.

**822. Use a comma to set off an informal quotation in direct discourse unless the quotation is short and is grammatically incorporated into the sentence.**

He said, "I am going home."

He answered "yes" to my question.

**823. Never use a comma between an adjective and the noun it modifies.**

*Wrong.* A blue, white, and red, flag hung from the window.

*Right.* A blue, white, and red flag hung from the window.



**824. Never use commas to set off clauses or phrases that limit the meaning of the expressions they modify; no punctuation is necessary.**

*Wrong.* All men, who do this, should be hanged.

*Right.* All men who do this should be hanged.

*Wrong.* Any woman, desiring to try for the team, should report immediately.

*Right.* Any woman desiring to try for the team should report immediately.

**825. Never use commas between adjectives in a series if the position of the adjectives cannot be logically interchanged.**

*Wrong.* He wore an old, black, felt hat.

*Right.* He wore an old black felt hat.

**826. Never use a comma to indicate a slight pause.**

*Wrong.* Through the window, jumped the cat.

*Right.* Through the window jumped the cat.

**827. Never use a comma before *that*, *what*, *how*, *why*, etc., in indirect discourse.**

He said that he would go tomorrow.

He asked me what I was going to do.

She inquired how they were to go.

They asked why their salaries had been decreased.

**828. Never use a comma between main clauses not joined by a conjunction; use a period. ([See 380.](#))**

*Wrong.* Tomorrow is Tuesday, you must come then.

*Right.* Tomorrow is Tuesday. You must come then.

**829. Use a semicolon (;) between co-ordinate clauses that are not joined by a co-ordinating conjunction.**

*Wrong.* He went to South America, I stayed at home.

*Right.* He went to South America; I stayed at home.

**830. Use a semicolon between clauses that are joined by conjunctive adverbs.**

She could not come; so there was no meeting.

I did not see him; nevertheless I knew he was there.

The men were none too sure of their next move; their doubt, however, only tended to heighten their excitement.

**831. Use a semicolon between co-ordinate clauses that are joined by *and* or *but* only if the clauses have more than ten words each, or if there are commas within the clauses.**

Slowly the huge grey transport that had been waiting at the dock since midnight got under way; and slowly the throng that had gathered for one last glimpse of relatives and friends made its way up the long street.

If we can find no other way, you may be sure we shall follow your advice; but you must not expect us to relinquish any more of our profit than we can help, especially at this late date.

**832. Never use a semicolon between a subordinate clause and a main clause.**

*Wrong.* Since they came; we have not had a moment's peace.

*Right.* Since they came, we have not had a moment's peace.

**833. Never use a semicolon after the salutation of a letter.**

*Wrong.* Dear Sir;

We are glad that you approve our action.

*Right.* Dear Sir:

We are glad that you approve our action.

**834. Use a colon (:) to introduce formally a word, a catalogue, a list, questions, statements, or long quotations.**

There was but one thing to do: retreat.

I was advised to see these men: C. R. Wright, A. W. Henderson, and B. L. Noojin.

The following will report in uniform tomorrow:

Butler

Doolittle

Thomas

Williams

The question then arose: What should we do with him?

What troubled us was this: The ammunition was running low.

This is the first sentence in Poe's *Fall of the House of Usher*: "During the whole of a dull, dark, and soundless day in the autumn of the year, when the clouds hung oppressively low in the heavens, I had been passing alone, on horseback, through a singularly dreary tract of country; and at length found myself, as the shades of evening drew on, within view of the melancholy House of Usher."

**835. Use a hyphen (-) in writing fractions, or numbers less than one hundred.**

Three-fifths, twenty-one, thirty-seconds.

Thirty-seven, ninety-nine.

**836. Use a hyphen in titles composed of two words or more.**

Lieutenant-colonel, alderman-at-large, editor-in-chief.

**837. Use a hyphen after the first part of a word divided at the end of a line.**

**838. Use a hyphen in compound adjectives.**

Light-blue, 70-horsepower, six-cylinder, seven-passenger, ill-advised.

**839. Use a hyphen after prefixes like *co-*, *re-*, *anti-*, *post-*, etc., when prefixed to words beginning with the last letter of the prefix; when prefixed to proper nouns or proper adjectives; when the compound might become confused with a word of similar spelling.**

Co-operation, anti-Christian, re-creation.

**840. Use a dash (—) when the thought is abruptly broken off.**

Just then the telephone rang—I wish I could remember who was calling.

**841. Use dashes rather than parentheses to inclose informal parenthetical material.**

He offered me—imagine it—twenty dollars a week.

**842. Use a dash before a summarizing expression.**

After the wheat is all in, after the horses are put up, and after the chores have been done—then you may use the car.

**843. Never use a dash where a period should be used.**

*Wrong.* Come tomorrow—everybody will be here then—

*Right.* Come tomorrow. Everybody will be here then.

**844. Never use a dash where a comma should be used.**

*Wrong.* Tom came in yesterday—and Jim was glad to see him.

*Right.* Tom came in yesterday, and Jim was glad to see him.

**845. Use quotation marks (“ ”) to inclose expressions in direct discourse.**

He said, “Let me try.”

**846. Use quotation marks to inclose material borrowed from some other writer.**

According to John Keats “A thing of beauty is a joy forever.”

**847. If the quoted passage contains more than one paragraph, the quotation marks must be placed at the beginning of each paragraph, but after only the last.**

**848. Use single quotation marks ( ‘ ’ ) to inclose a quotation within a quotation.**

The man said, “John said to me, ‘You hold him; I’m busy.’”

**849. Use ordinary quotation marks to inclose material quoted within a passage enclosed by single quotation marks.**

She said, “Jane replied, ‘Jim’s remark, “Iowa has a hard schedule next year,” does not mean what you think it means.’”

**850. Include periods and commas at the end of quoted material within the quotation marks, but treat other marks of punctuation according to the context of the passage.**

**851. Underscore names of books, plays, musical compositions, paintings, and pieces of sculpture. Do not use quotation marks.**

George Eliot’s Silas Marner has been read by thousands.

**852. Use an apostrophe ( ’ ) to mark the omission of letters in contracted words.**

*Wrong.* Dont, cant, its (for *it is*), Ive, doesnt.

*Right.* Don’t, can’t, it’s, I’ve, doesn’t.

**853. Use an apostrophe before the s to form the possessive of singular nouns.**

*Wrong.* Fathers house has just been painted.

*Right.* Father’s house has just been painted.

**854. Use an apostrophe after the s to form the possessive of plural nouns.**

*Wrong.* They sell boys clothing.

*Wrong.* They sell boy's clothing.

*Right.* They sell boys' clothing.

**855. Never use an apostrophe to form the possessive of personal pronouns.**

*Wrong.* Their's are black.

*Right.* Theirs are black.

**856. Use parentheses ( ) to inclose material that is foreign to the main thought of a sentence, paragraph, or whole composition.**

*Right.* They will (I saw the order myself) withdraw the Second battalion tomorrow.

**857. Use parentheses to inclose figures that confirm numerical adjectives. Place the figures in parentheses after the numeral word.**

*Wrong.* He offered to sell me (5) five mules.

*Right.* He offered to sell me five (5) mules.

**858. Never use parentheses to cancel a word which you want to omit; draw a line through it.**

*Wrong.* Next week the (whether) weather will be warm.

*Right.* Next week the ~~whether~~ weather will be warm.

**859. Use brackets [ ] to inclose explanatory material introduced into a quotation.**

The speaker said, "He [Washington] was above everything else an American gentleman."

**860. Practice.**

Paragraph and punctuate the following passages.

## I

I had been going to St Lukes Hospital in Charleston S C every day for two weeks to visit my brother John who had to undergo a serious operation Dr R L Spitzenberg one of the best surgeons in the city was in charge of the case one day it was I think March 12 1919 I asked the doctor when John might be taken home he exclaimed my dear sir how can you expect to move a man who is as weak as your brother is naturally I was disappointed but John was more then disappointed for he had become very tired of the hospital routine he sighed deeply he turned his face to the wall and wept sobbingly when he had become somewhat quieted a nurse came in with his evening meal she was rather small not particularly pretty and unusually brusque I thought in manner the meal consisted of a small well-cooked steak hot baked potatoes and a combination salad I sat beside the bed as he tried to eat and wondered why they gave him such heavy food if he were so weak finally I said nurse are all patients given the same diet not two minutes before she had been staring out the window in a vacuous sort of way at my question however she turned and with no apparent change in her manner remarked how should I know Ive just been taken on.

## II

The lecturer said in part let me begin by quoting the hounds of spring are on winters traces and the mother of months in meadow and plain fills the shadows and windy places with lisp of leaves and ripple of rain could anything more precisely convey the restless sensitive mood of spring I can think of nothing he Swinburne the author seems to have grasped the very essence of spring here and made it live forever in his lines let me pause here a moment to suggest that if anyone of you is looking for poetry that really sings try Swinburne he will always satisfy the ear but poetry is not all sound however it must if it is to appeal popularly have rhythm to be sure nevertheless this rhythm must never be allowed to become monotonous try reading Popes Rape of the Lock for instance aloud what was it Wordsworth said poetry was emotion recollected in tranquillity or something like that wasn't it indeed nothing could be more easily demonstrable Bret Harte for example in Gabriel Conroy describes a snow storm to perfection one finds himself floundering through the drifts as truly as if he were actually in the

midst of the storm yet Harte wrote the passage long after he had undergone the experience set forth and far from the scene itself in fact he wrote of a storm in the West in midwinter while sitting calmly at his desk in New York in midsummer.



## CHAPTER XIII

### MECHANICS

In putting your ideas upon paper you must follow certain customs which good taste and convenience have established as correct at the present time. Since manners change from generation to generation, however, and since writing machines and printing methods are constantly being improved, some of these customs necessarily vary. The ensuing rules, therefore, have been composed in accordance with the best present usage and are passed on to you as describing those customs which are least subject to change.

#### Manuscript

- 900. Write upon only one side of the paper.**
- 901. Place the title upon the first line, or about two inches from the top of the sheet.**
- 902. Leave one line blank between the title and the body of the composition.**
- 903. Write legibly and without flourishes, using black ink.**
- 904. Number the pages in the upper right-hand corner.**
- 905. Leave the space of the letter *m* after each mark of punctuation within the sentence, and the space of three *m*'s after marks of end punctuation.**
- 906. Never crowd a word in order to get it all upon one line. Divide the word and mark the division with a hyphen.**
- 907. Place the hyphen that marks the division of a word at the end of a line after the first part of the word. Do NOT place a hyphen before**

the second part of the word. Divide a word only at the end of a syllable.

908. Maintain a left-hand margin of at least an inch, and endeavor to keep the right-hand margin even.

909. Indent each paragraph half an inch.

910. Never write below the last line upon a ruled sheet. In typewritten manuscript leave at least half an inch at the bottom of the page.

### **Underscoring**

911. Underscore a word once for italics, twice for small capital letters, and three times for large capital letters.

912. Never underscore a word for emphasis.

### **Footnotes**

913. Use superior figures for footnotes, placing the figure after the expression referred to.

914. Place footnotes at the bottom of the page preceded by the superior figure corresponding to that used in the text.

### **Abbreviations**

915. Use no abbreviations in formal composition except *Mr.*, *Mrs.*, or *Dr.*

### **Capitals**

916. Begin all proper nouns and proper adjectives with a capital letter.

Russia, Bible, Pike's Peak, English, Christian, Napoleonic.

917. Begin the first word of every sentence with a capital letter.

**918. Begin every line of verse with a capital letter.**

**919. Begin every direct quotation with a capital letter.**

**920. Begin each important word in the name of a social, a political, or a religious organization with a capital letter.**

Sigma Delta Chi, Democratic party, Unitarian church.

**921. Begin every word that refers to the Deity with a capital letter.**

**922. Capitalize the pronoun *I* and the interjection *O*.**

**923. Begin the important words in the names of books, of plays, of musical compositions, of paintings and of pieces of sculpture with capital letters.**

**924. Begin with capital letters personal titles when they are written with personal names.**

Colonel Morrison, Professor Hunt, Secretary McAdoo.

**925. Begin the names of months, days of the week, and holidays with capital letters.**

## **Figures**

**926. Write out in full only those numbers that can be expressed in two words.**

Ninety-nine, fifty thousand, one million.

**927. Write out in full sums of money in even dollars which can be expressed in two words; otherwise use the dollar sign and figures.**

**928. Use the dollar sign and figures for sums of money in dollars and cents.**

**929. Write out in full sums of money less than one dollar.**

**930. Write out in full numbers used as names of streets or districts.**

Fifty-fifth street.

**931. Never begin a sentence with a number expressed in figures.**

**932. Write out in full sums of money used as adjectives.**

She bought six-dollar gloves.

### **Letters**

**933. Write the full address of the writer and the date of writing in every letter, preferably at the head.**

**934. Use one of the following forms for the salutation of a business letter:**

Dear Sir:

Gentlemen:

Ladies:

Sir:

Madam:

My dear Sir:

My dear Madam:

My dear Mr. Higginbottom:

My dear Mrs. Higginbottom:

**935. Use one of the following forms for the salutation of a personal letter:**

My dear Mrs. Wilson,

Dear Dr. Albright,

Dear Brown,

Dear Miss Henry,

Dear Peter,

**936. Use one of the following forms for the closing phrase of a business letter:**

Yours very truly,  
Very truly yours,  
Yours truly,  
Yours respectfully,  
Respectfully yours,

**937. Use one of the following forms for the closing phrase of a personal letter:**

Yours truly,  
Sincerely yours,  
Yours sincerely,

**938. Write the envelope address in not more than four lines.**

**939. Omit punctuation after each line of the envelope address.**

**940. Be consistent in the use of the third person in formal notes.**

**941. Sign letters clearly so that the signature can be easily read.**

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